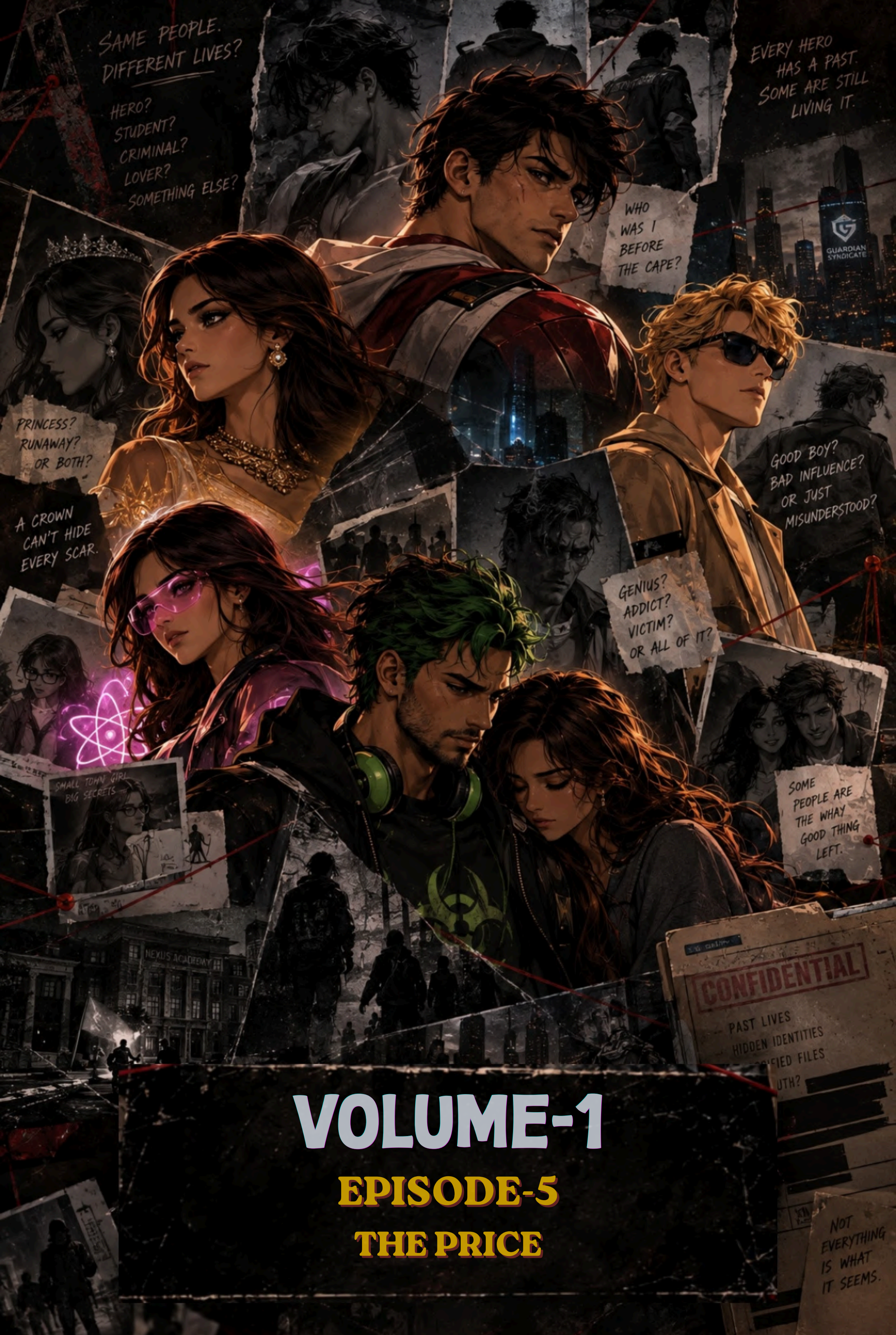




SAME PEOPLE.
DIFFERENT LIVES?

HERO?
STUDENT?
CRIMINAL?
LOVER?
SOMETHING ELSE?

EVERY HERO
HAS A PAST.
SOME ARE STILL
LIVING IT.

WHO
WAS I
BEFORE
THE CAPE?

PRINCESS?
RUNAWAY?
OR BOTH?

A CROWN
CAN'T HIDE
EVERY SCAR.

GENIUS?
ADDICT?
VICTIM?
OR ALL OF IT?

GOOD BOY?
BAD INFLUENCE?
OR JUST
MISUNDERSTOOD?

SMALL TOWN GIRL
BIG SECRETS

SOME
PEOPLE ARE
THE WHAY
GOOD THING
LEFT.

CONFIDENTIAL

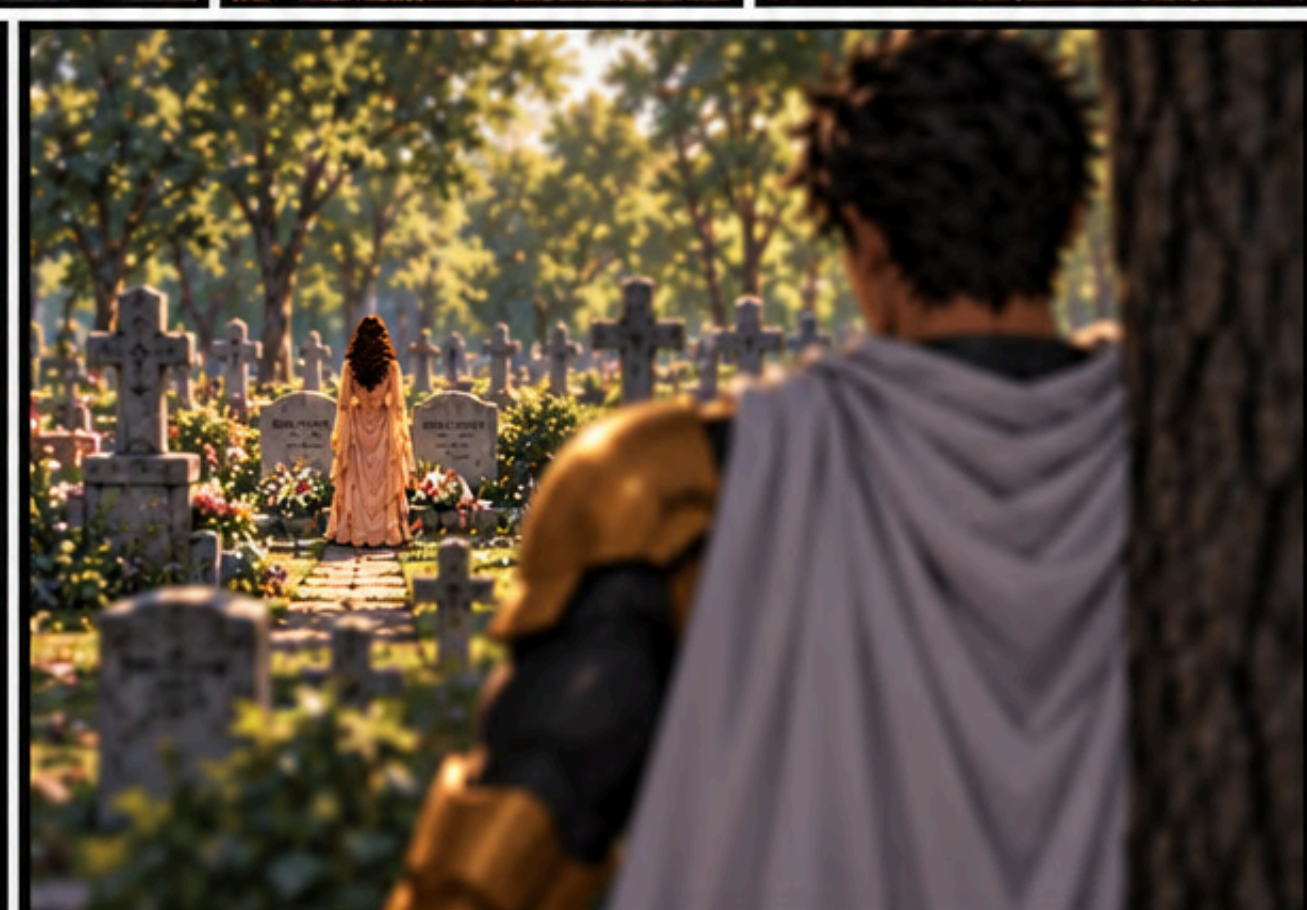
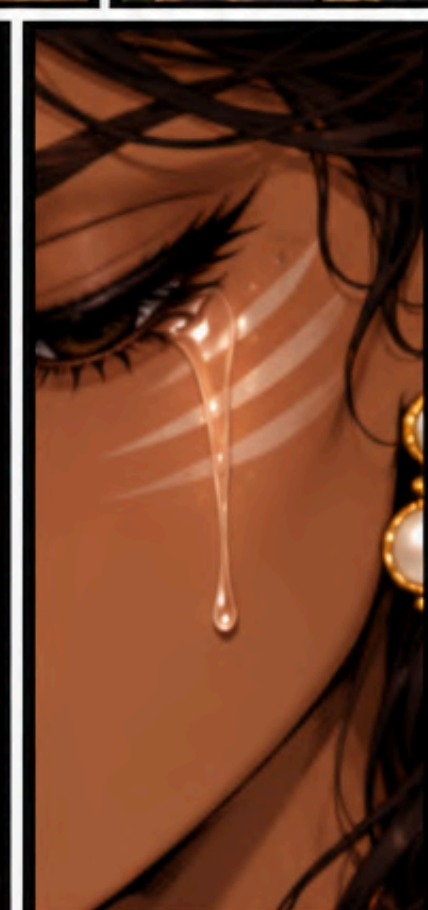
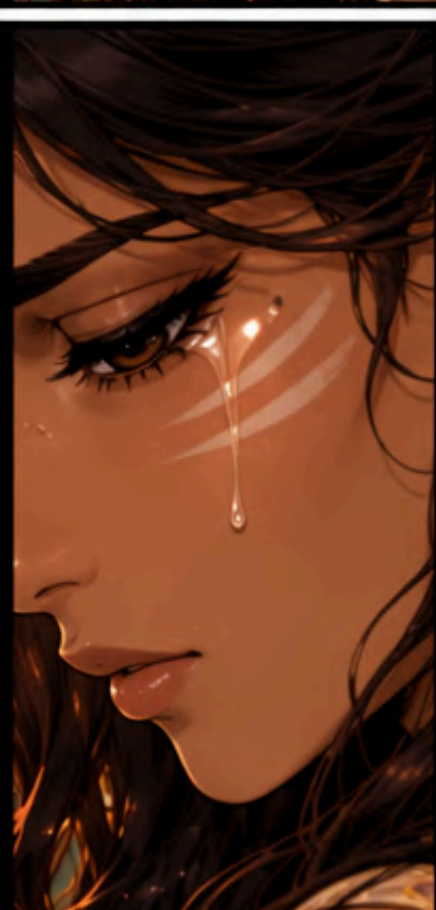
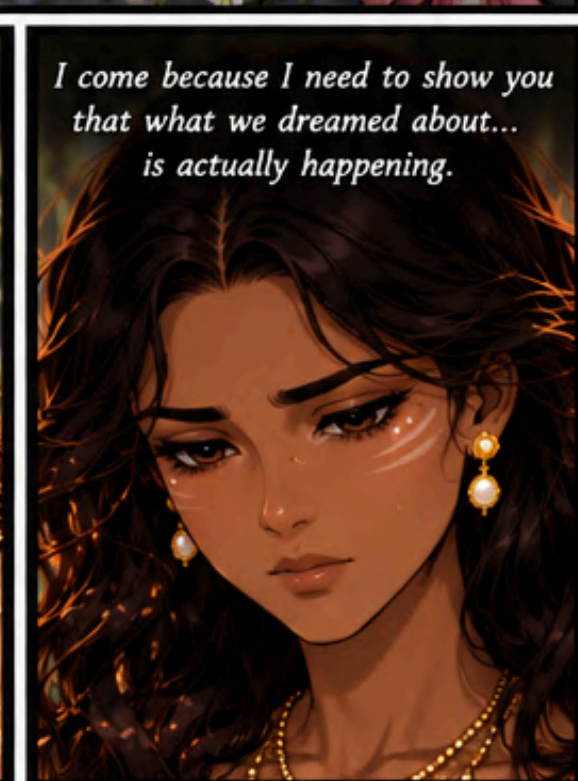
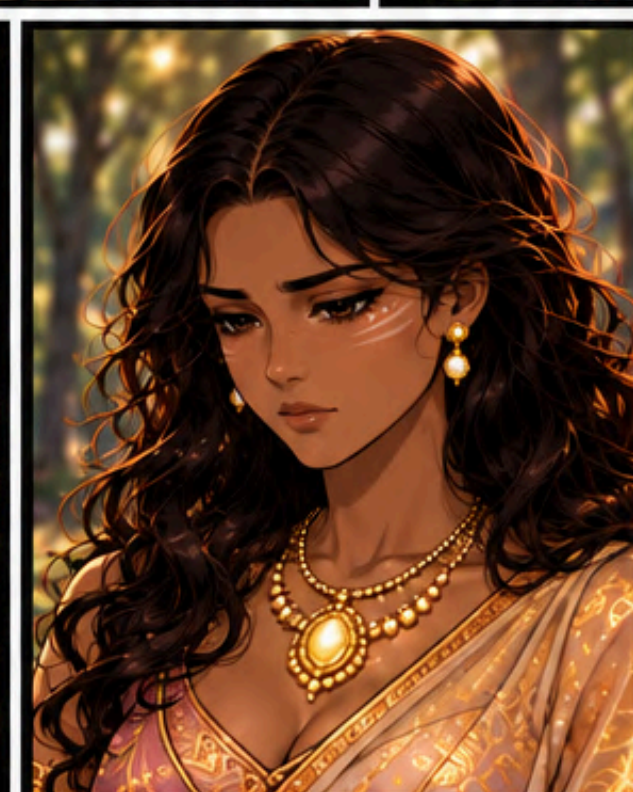
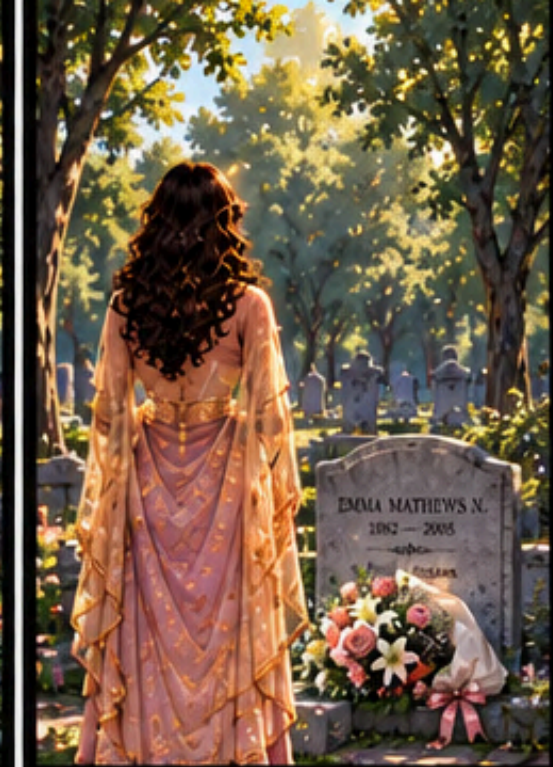
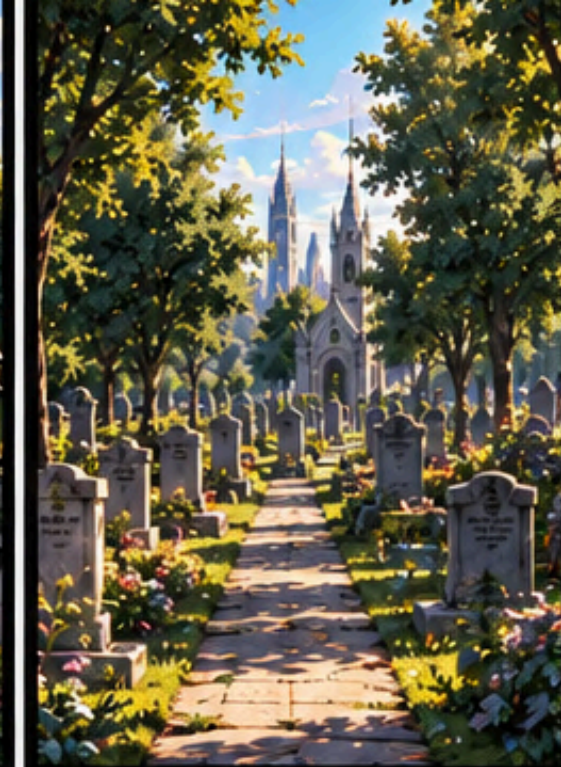
PAST LIVES
HIDDEN IDENTITIES
REFILED FILES
UTH?

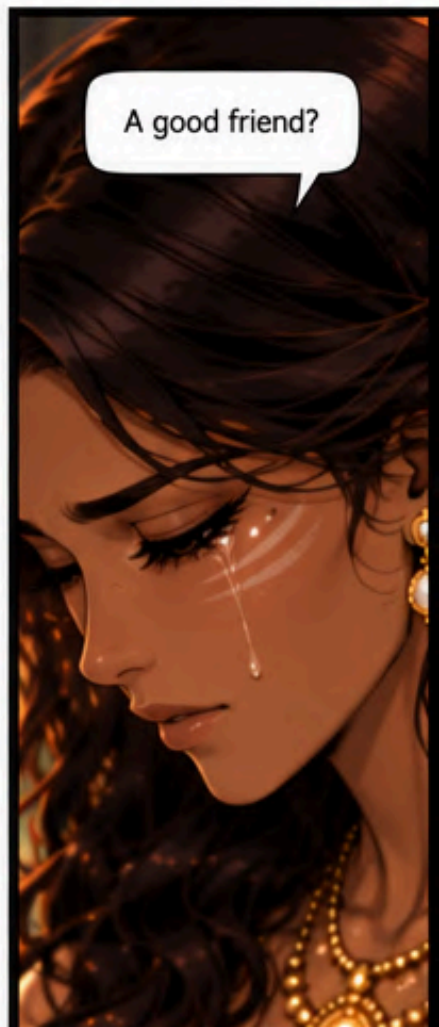
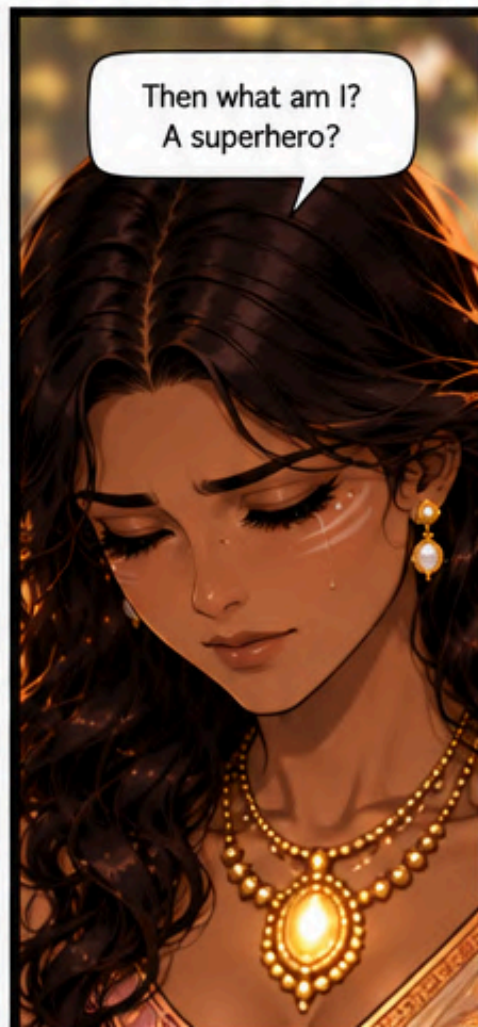
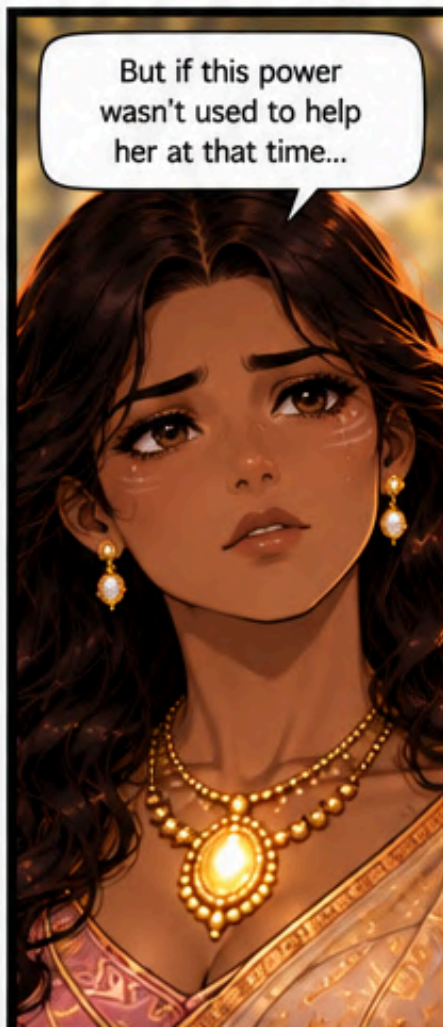
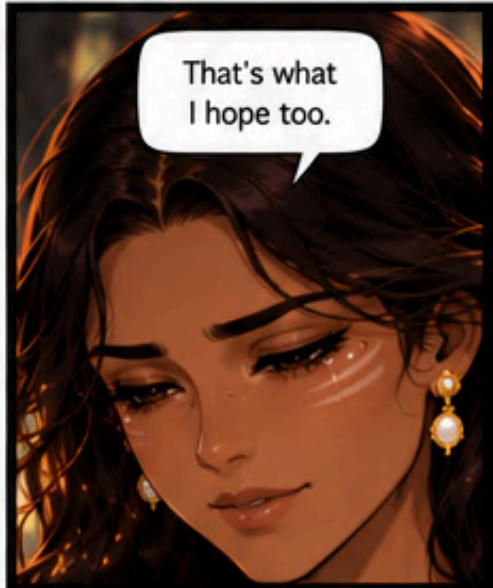
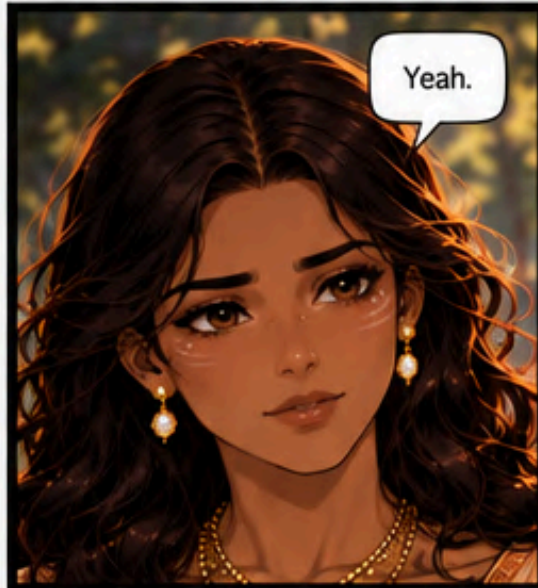
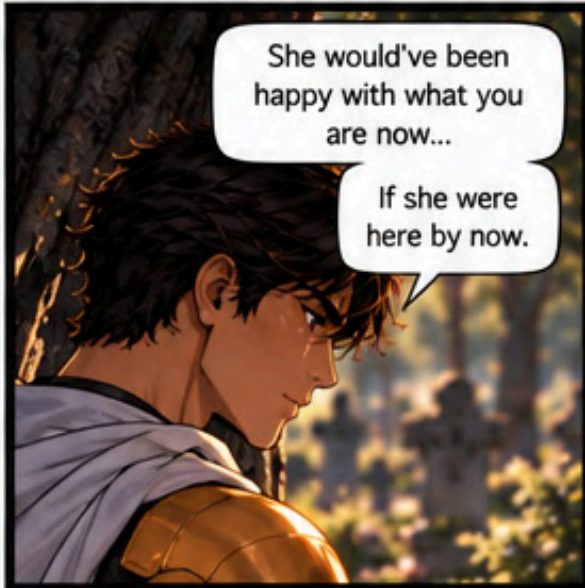
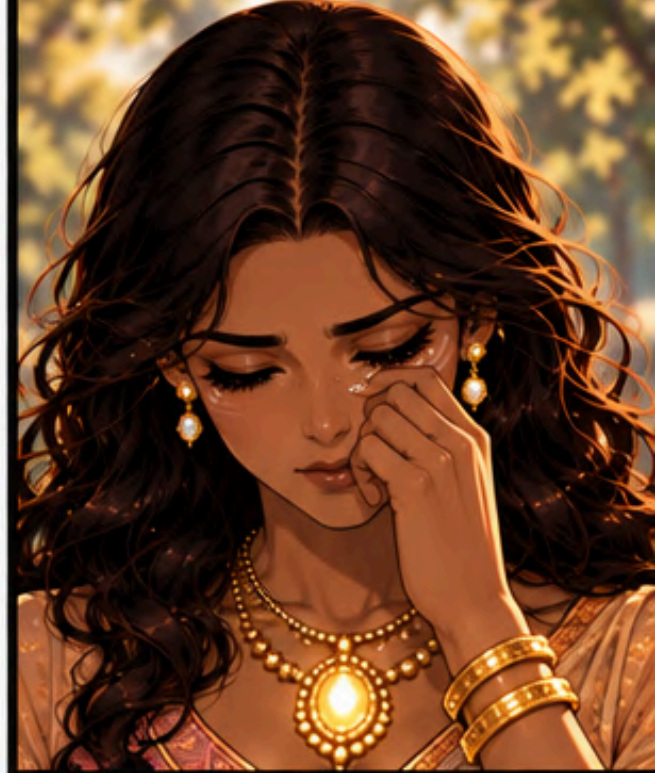
NOT
EVERYTHING
IS WHAT
IT SEEMS.

VOLUME-1

EPISODE-5

THE PRICE







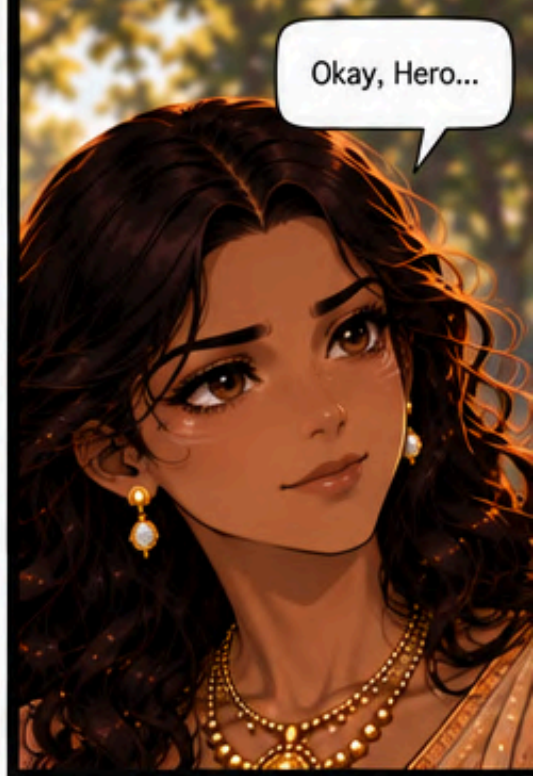
You are a Queen.



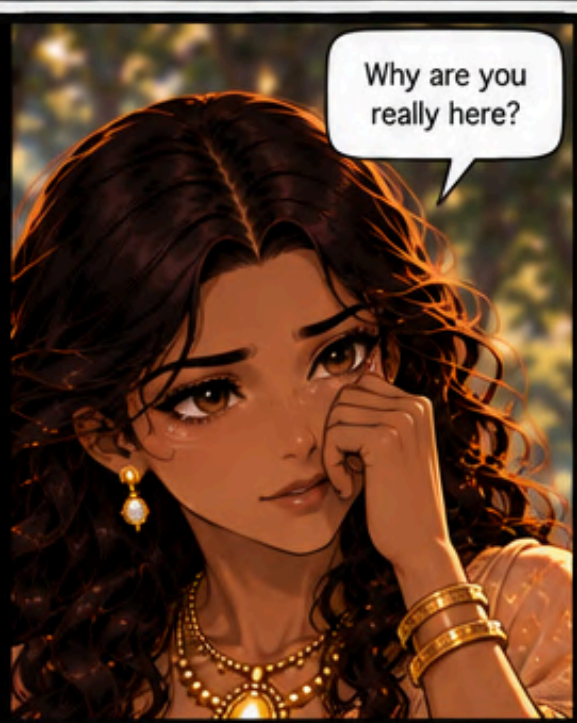
For the result of that one life you couldn't save, you saved millions.



And you're one of the reasons there's a city sleeping peacefully tonight.



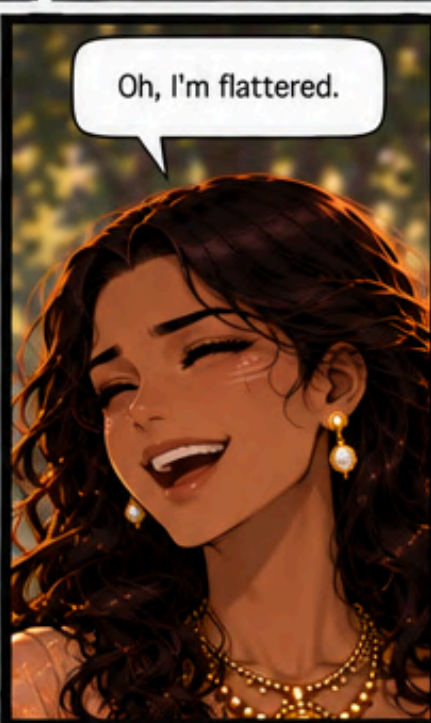
Okay, Hero...



Why are you really here?



I came to see my friend.



Oh, I'm flattered.

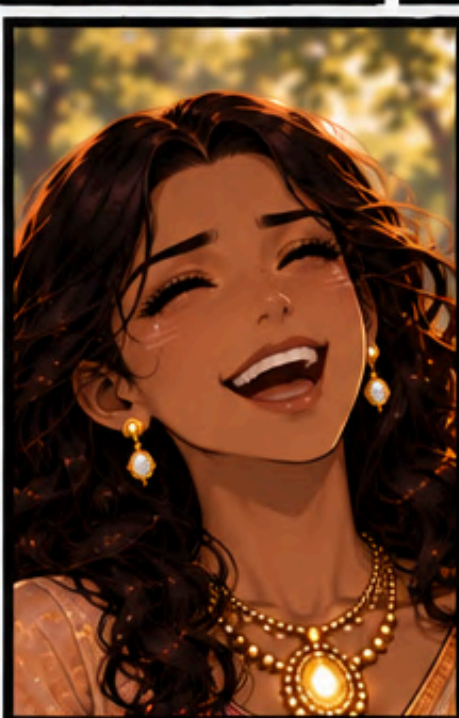


Just spill the tea, man.



Okaaay...

You really are some mind-reading witch, huh?



You know the dream I've been telling you about.

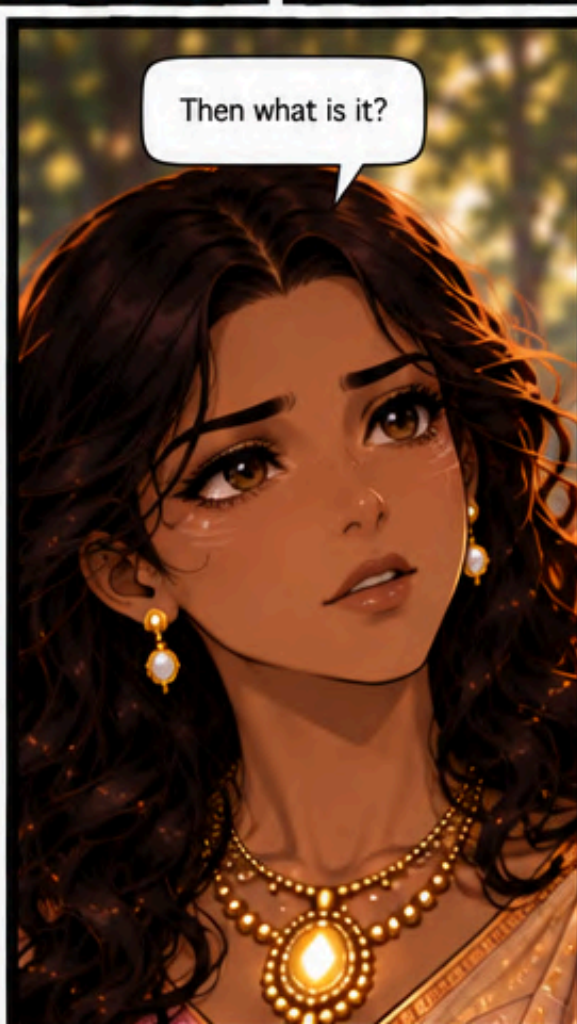
It keeps trying to tell me something.

Yeah.



I don't know exactly what yet.

But it was never just a dream.



Then what is it?



A way to something.

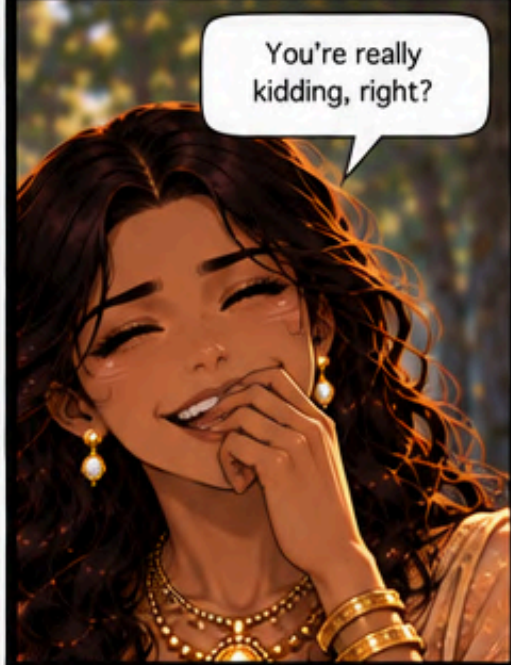


Like one of those one-eyed raven stories?



Yeah.
But can you put some spell on me so I can actually see the whole dream clearly?

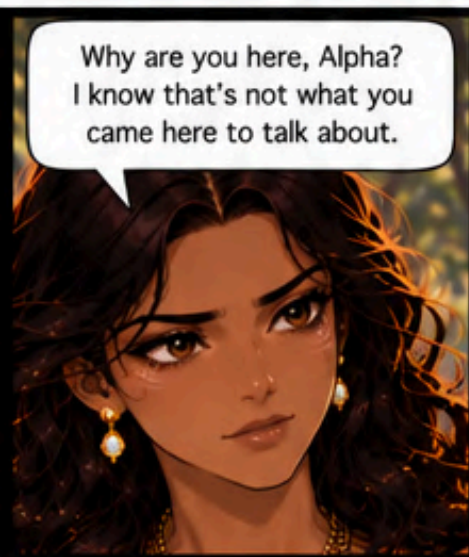
Haha...



You're really kidding, right?



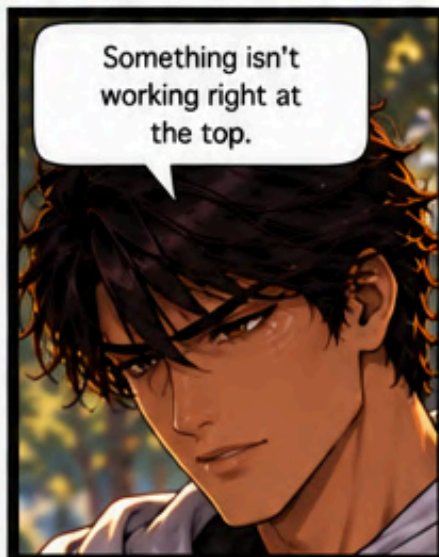
Do you actually think I'm a witch?
Come on.
Get to the real point.



Why are you here, Alpha?
I know that's not what you came here to talk about.



Huh...
It's the organisation, Kat.



Something isn't working right at the top.

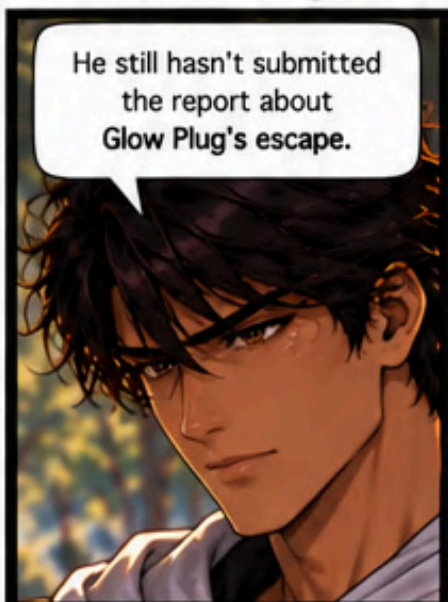


Your suspicions about Taylor?

Stronger now.



Maybe it's not only because of what he's been doing.
But something is off.



He still hasn't submitted the report about Glow Plug's escape.



And there's more.
What was the Syndicate doing when Chilltank was planting those bombs?

Where were they while we were fighting him?



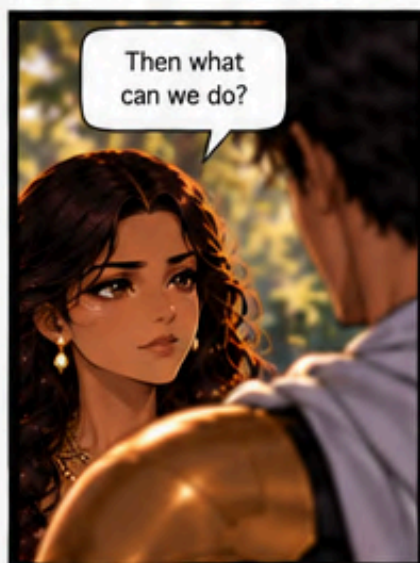
And where were they when Extinct had already informed them that he needed backup?



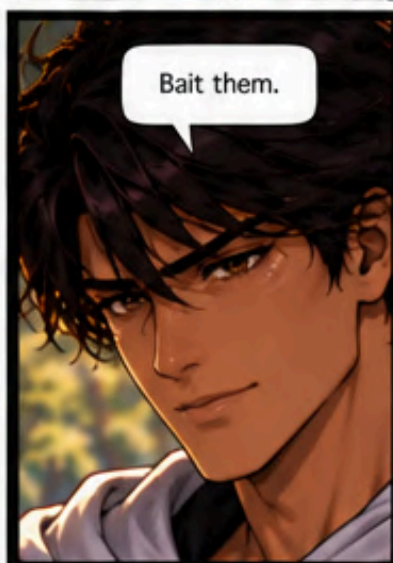
Mmm...



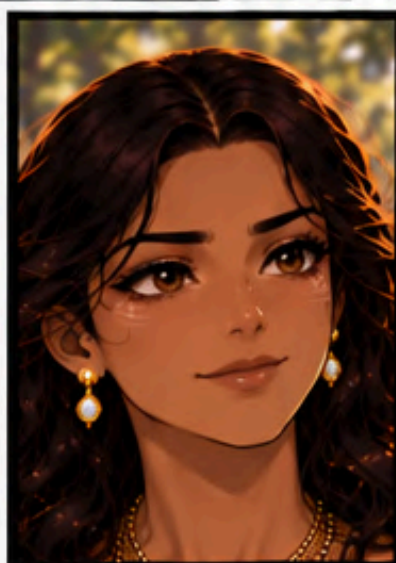
Something is happening within the organisation.



Then what can we do?



Bait them.



*Neither needed to explain the plan.
They trusted each other.
And whatever they were about to do...
someone was going to take the bait.*



The morning was peaceful. Daru walked through a busy shopping street with her father and mother, dressed in ordinary clothes rather than her Atom Girl costume.



What do you think about this?



No way, Dad.

Why?



That style is ancient.



This one.

You think this is better?



Definitely.

You need to keep up with the trend, Dad.



Hmm...

Maybe you are right.



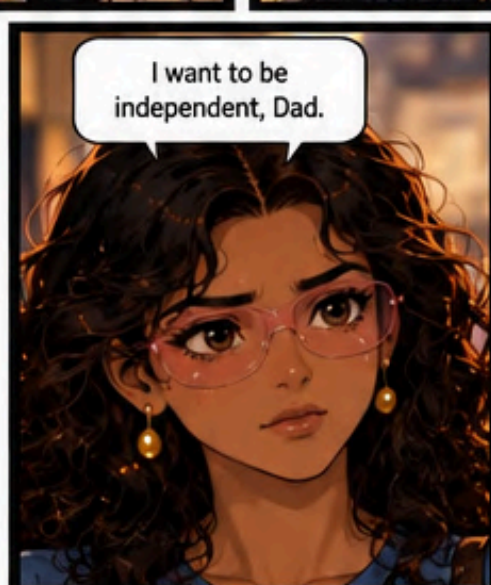
Darm...

What?



Tell me something.

What do you really want?



I want to be independent, Dad.

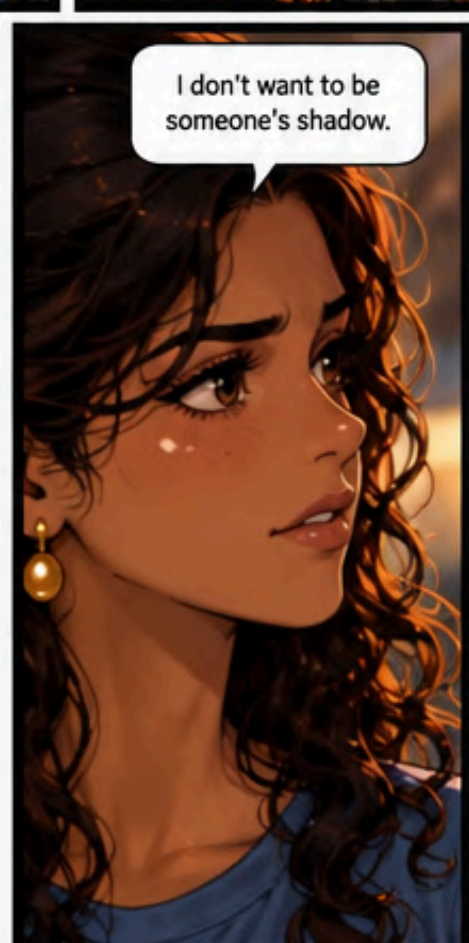


Independent? In what?

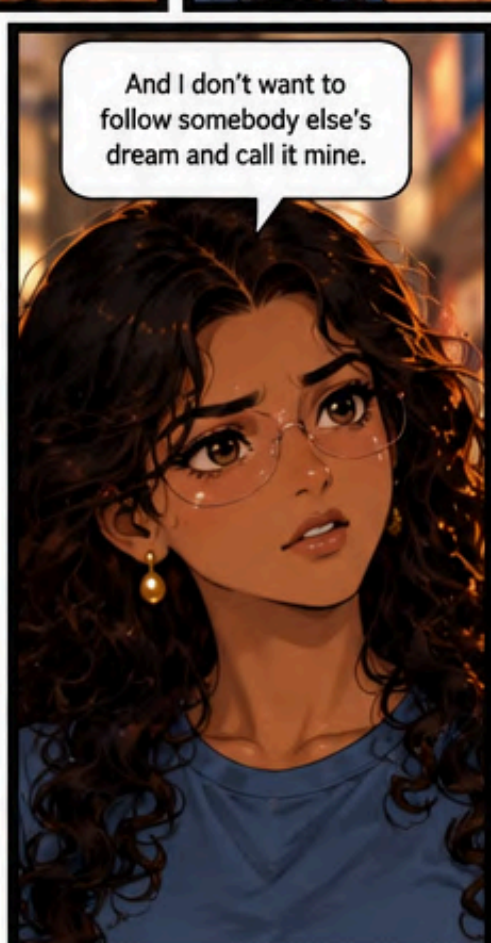


In everything.

I want my own place in the Guardians.



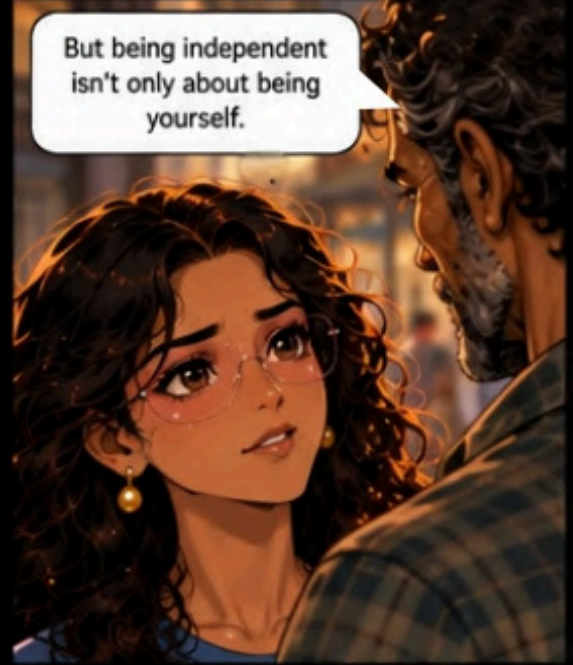
I don't want to be someone's shadow.



And I don't want to follow somebody else's dream and call it mine.



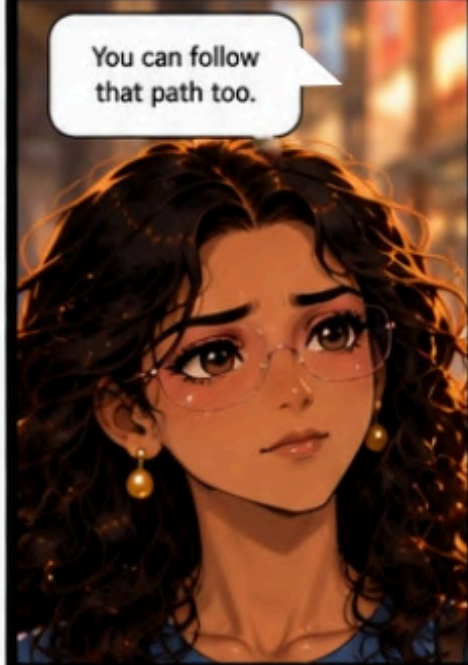
I understand you, Daru.



But being independent isn't only about being yourself.



We can also show you the path, can't we?



You can follow that path too.

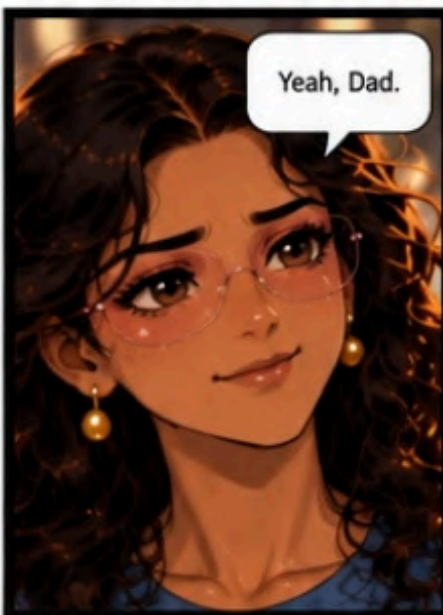
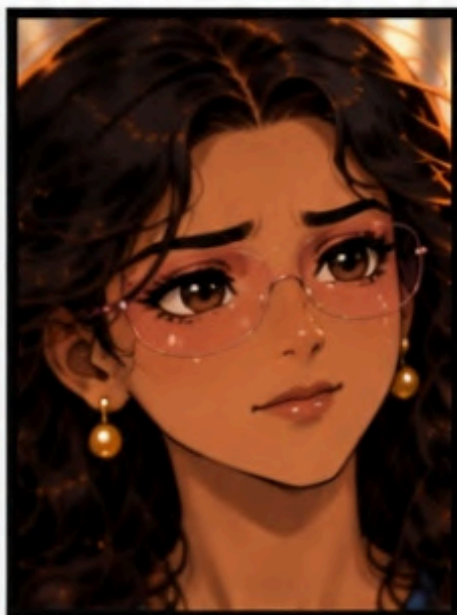


You'll become more successful...

...and more famous than anyone.



Even better than Alpha Void.



Yeah, Dad.



I'll see to it.



Actually, I want to leave now.

So soon?

Yeah.



Bye, Mom.



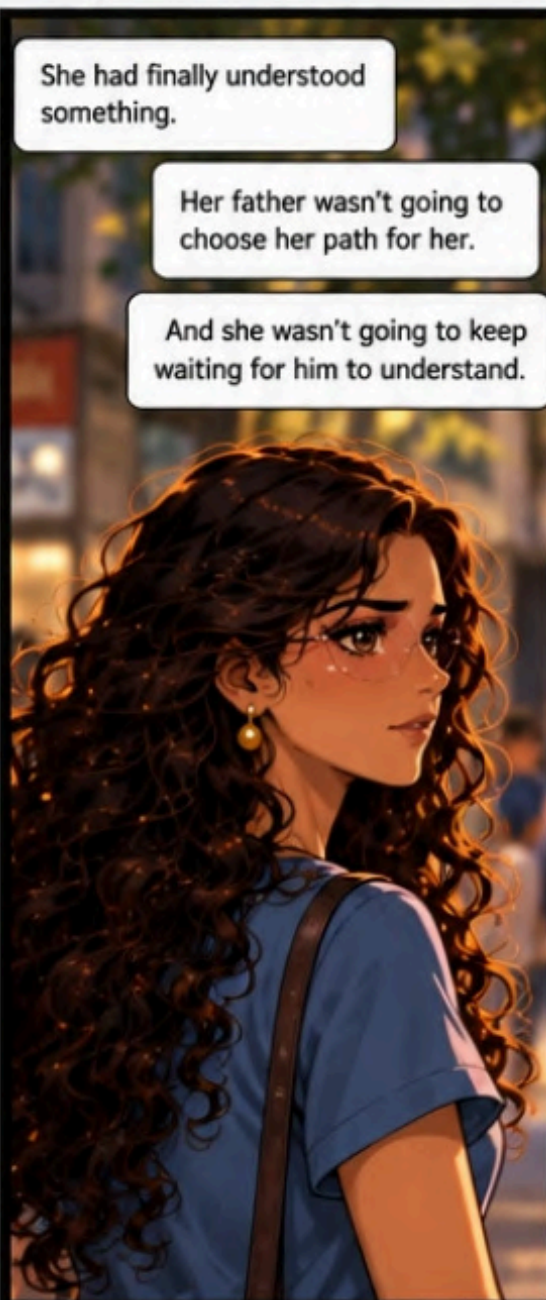
Bye, Dad.



Bye, Daru.



With every step, her expression became more determined.



She had finally understood something.

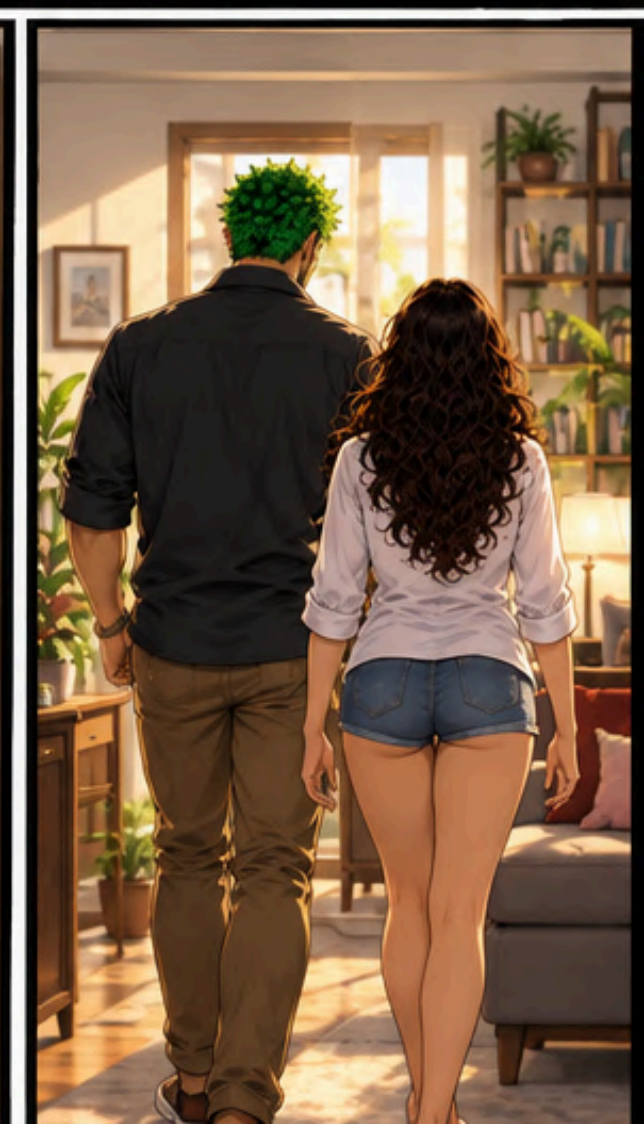
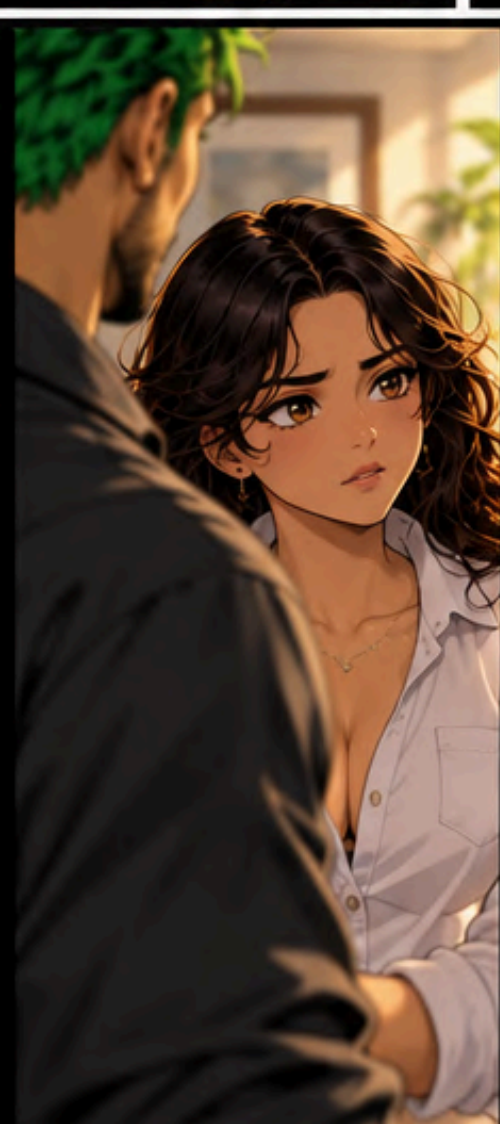
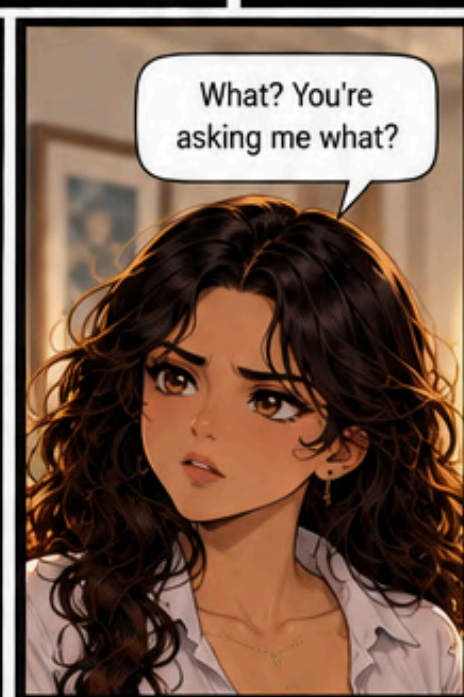
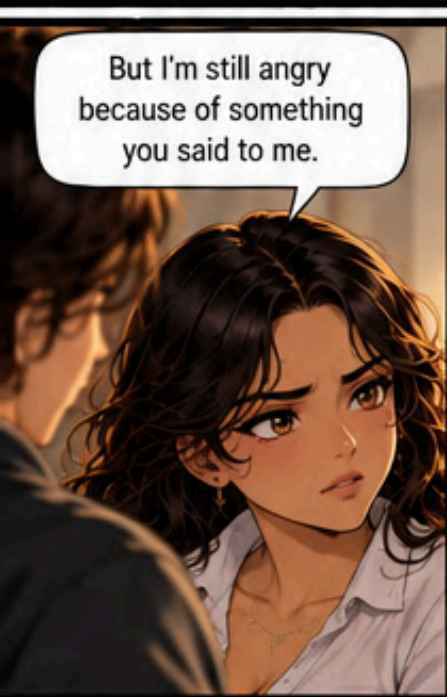
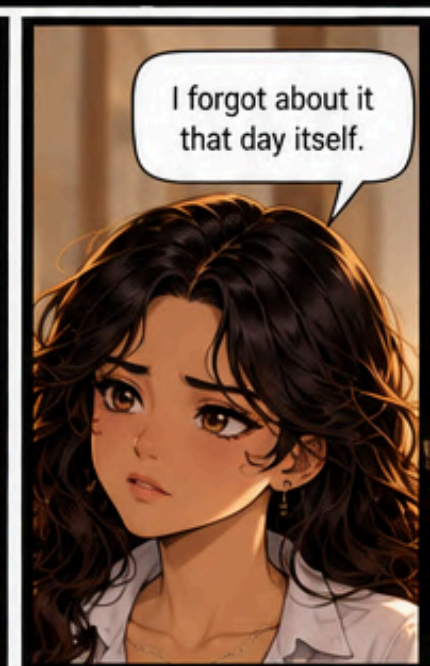
Her father wasn't going to choose her path for her.

And she wasn't going to keep waiting for him to understand.



This time, she knew exactly what she had to do.

She would choose her own way.

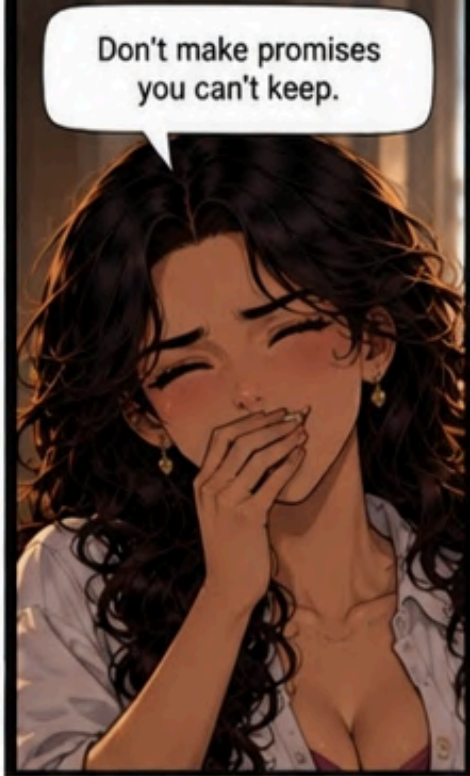
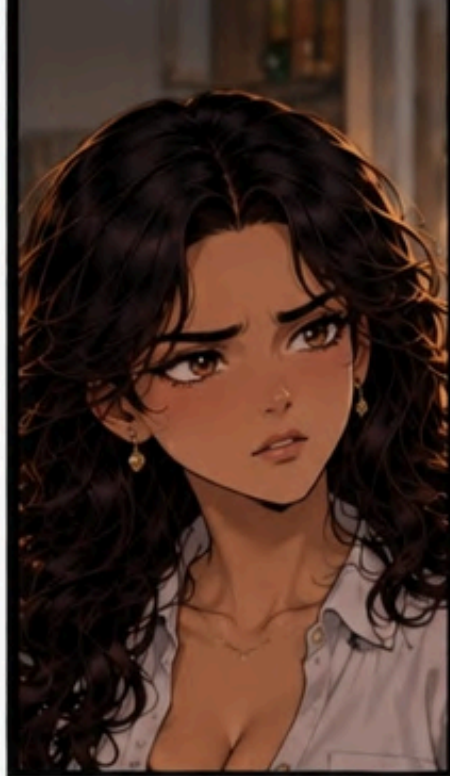




So...
Can we go out today?



I promise I'll be early.
Five minutes early, even.



Don't make promises
you can't keep.



Do you know
what day it is today?

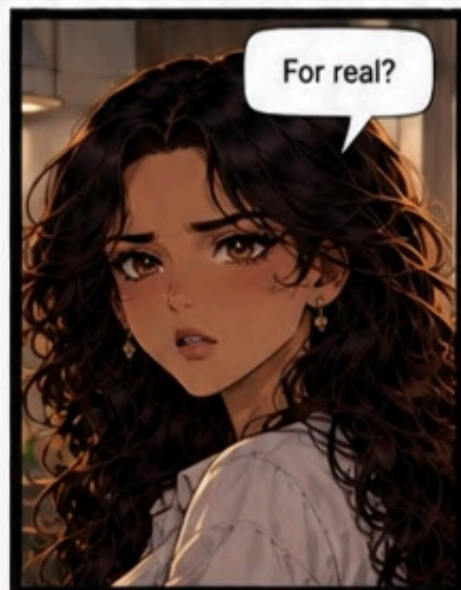


Ahhh...



Tuesday, right?

Haha.



For real?



What?

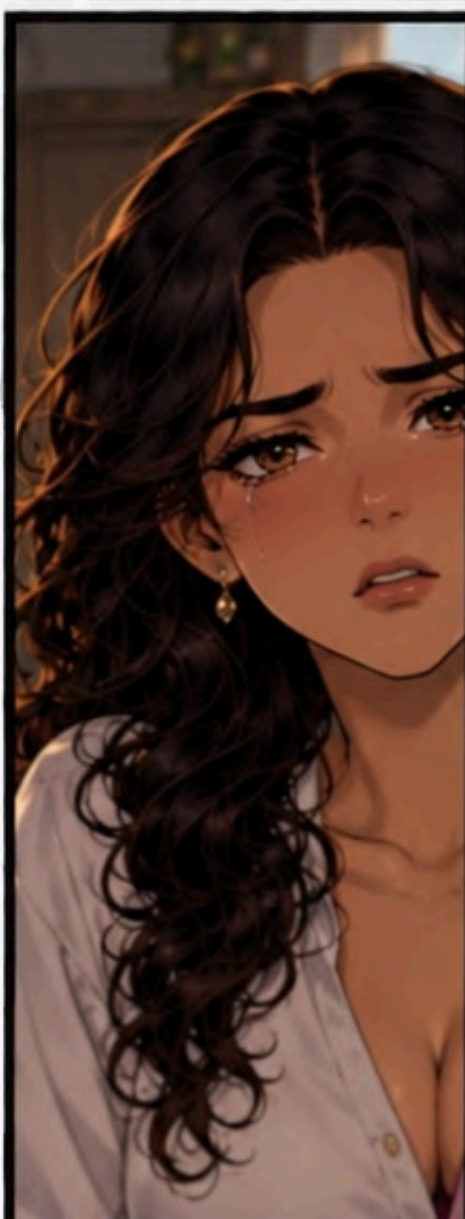
You forgot this?



What?

Definitely not
your birthday...

And definitely not
your mother's
birthday either.



How can you forget...

Our baby's
death day?



Mandice...



I'm sorry. I'm sorry. I didn't mean to forget that.

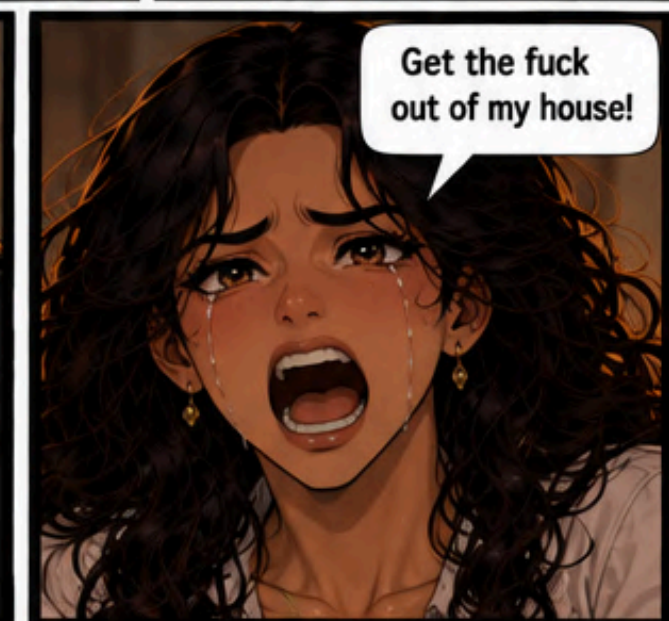


I've just been so busy with that fight and all this—



Get out.

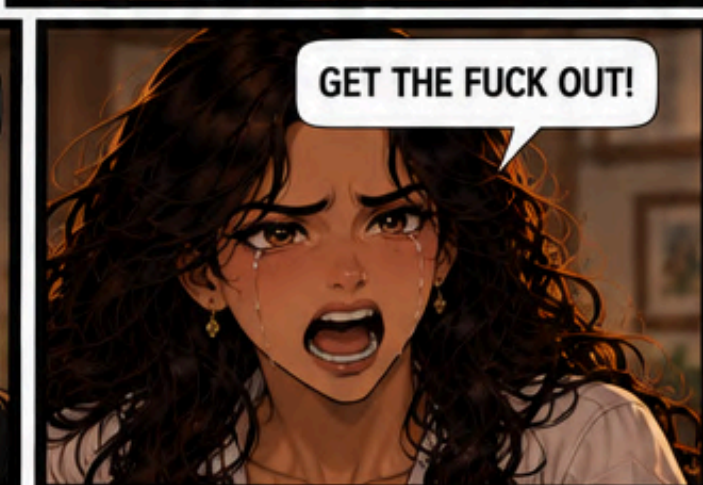
Mandice?



Get the fuck out of my house!



Mandice, I—



GET THE FUCK OUT!



He said nothing. He slowly walked toward the door. He knew he'd made another terrible mistake.



Mandice, I'm—

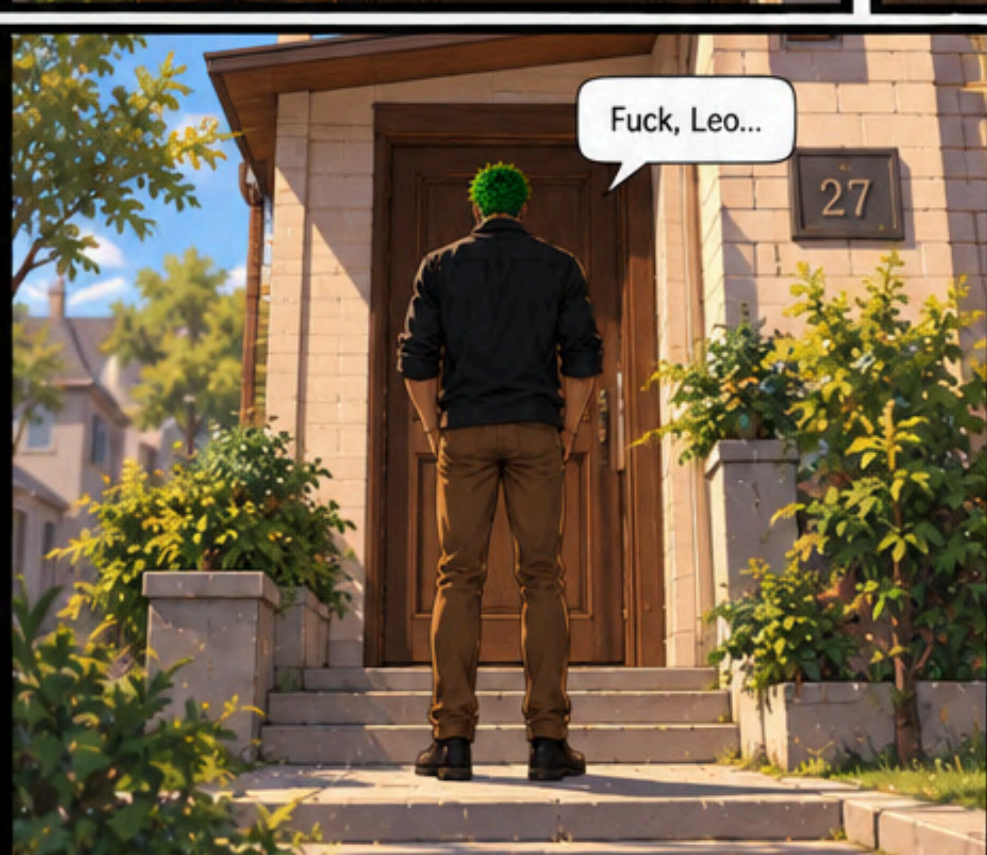
SLAM!



All those years. All those memories.

And somehow, she was still living with a man who could save hundreds of people without thinking twice...

...but couldn't remember the most painful day of their lives.



Fuck, Leo...



How did you forget this?



Shit...
you absolutely
fucked up, Leo.



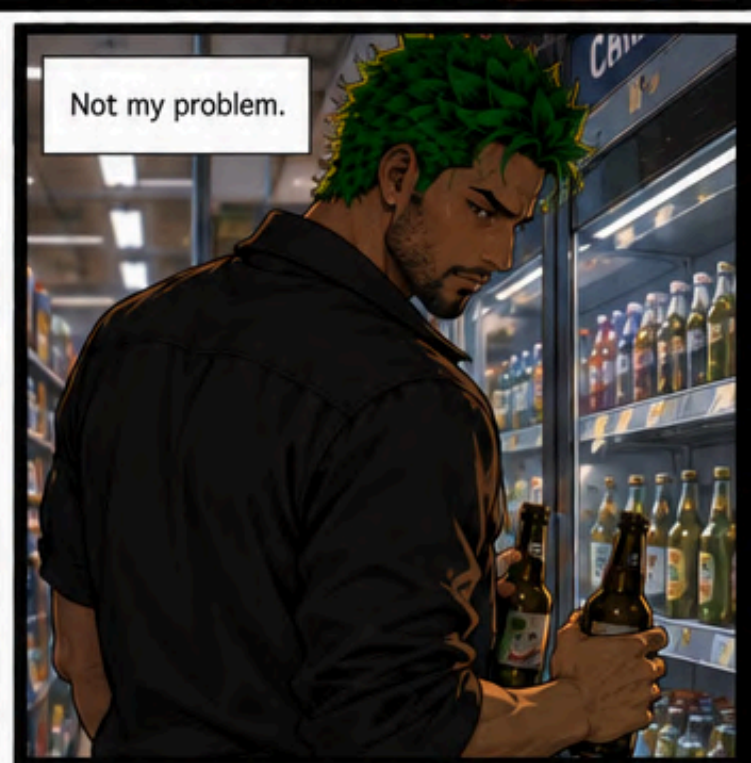
KICK



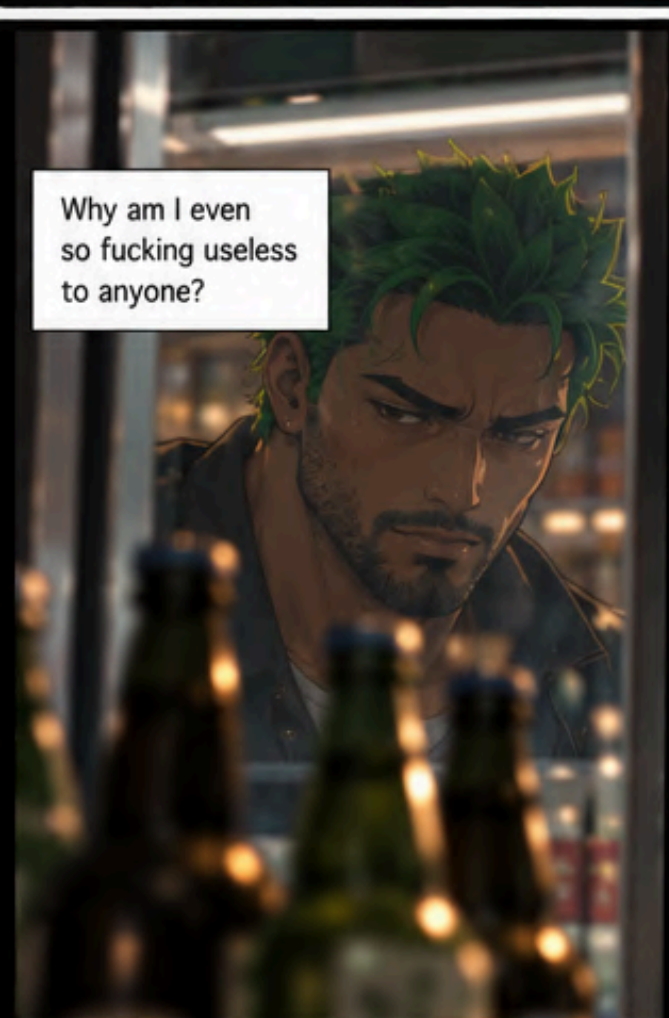
Take all the fucking
money!



And put it inside
this bag, chick!

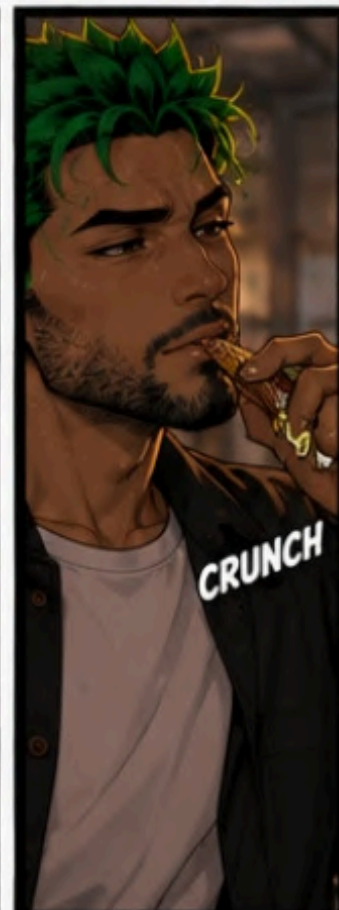
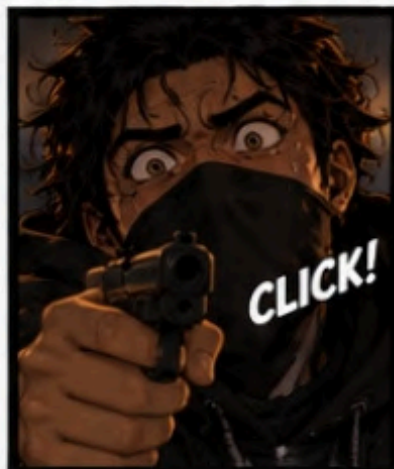
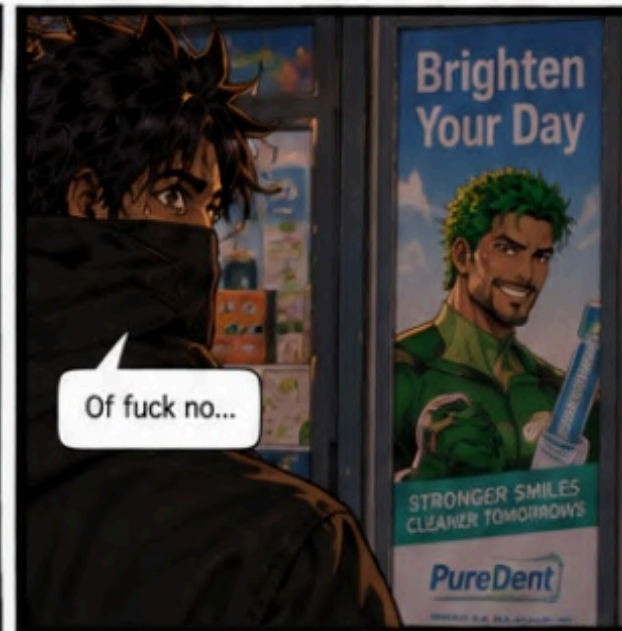
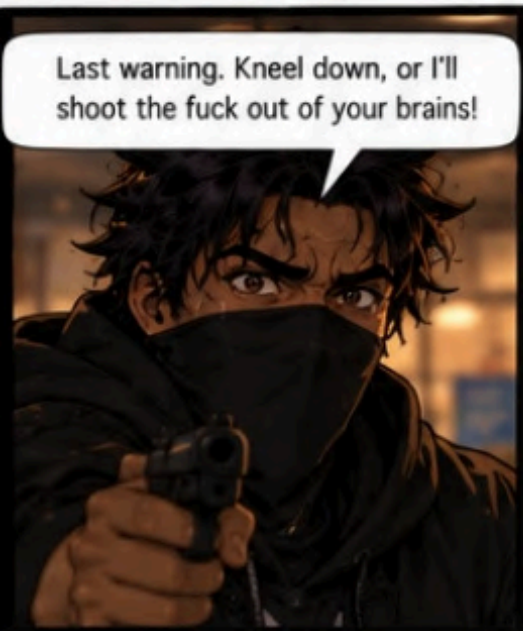


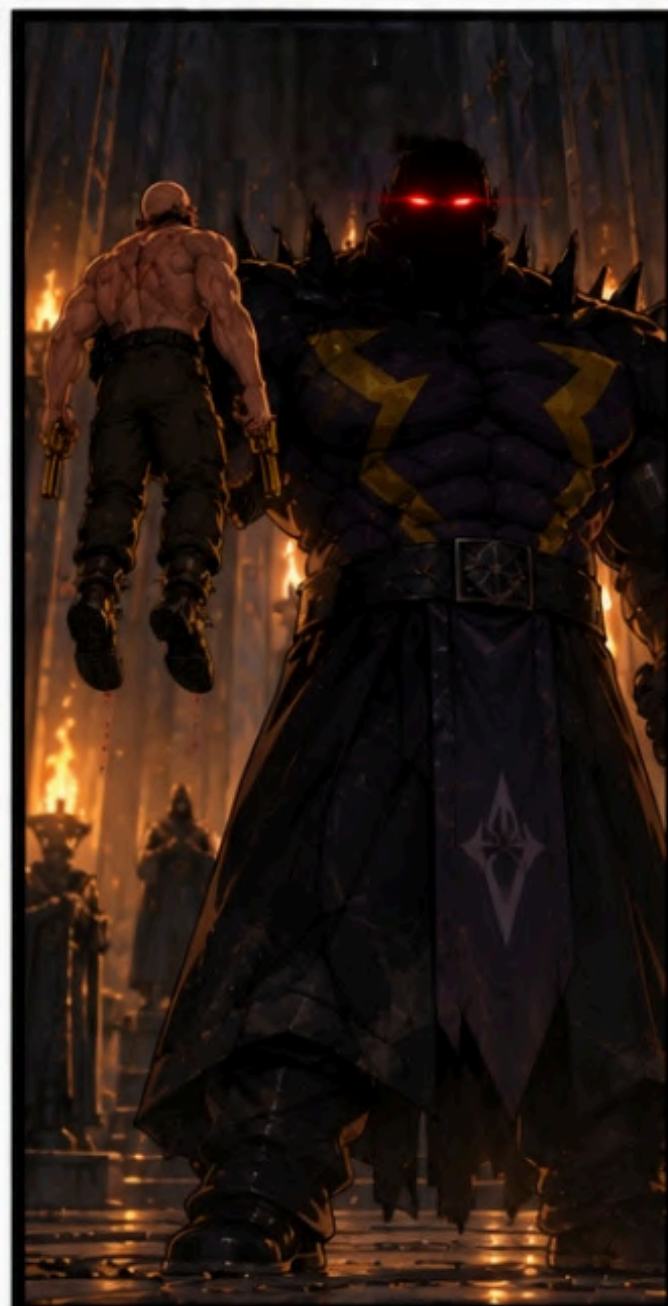
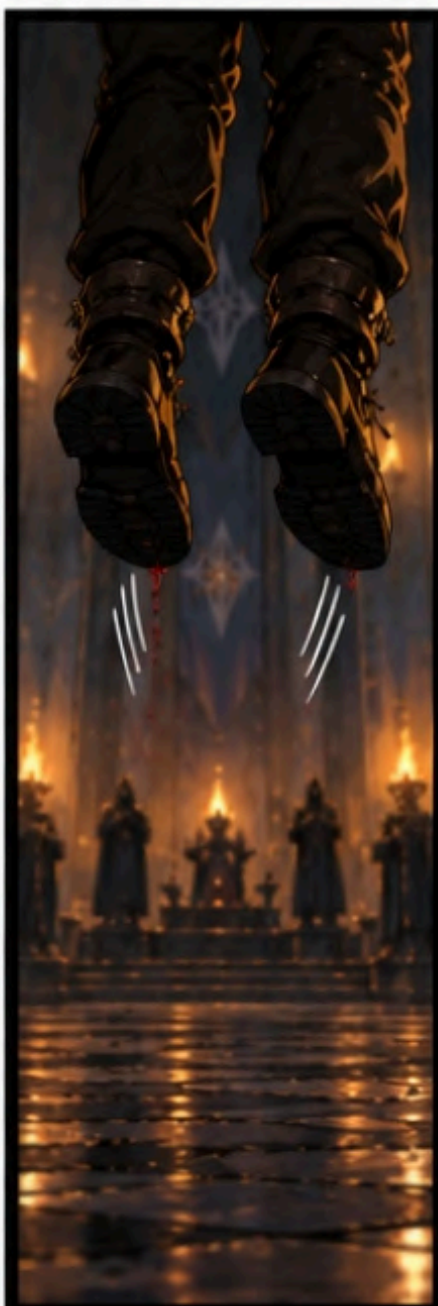
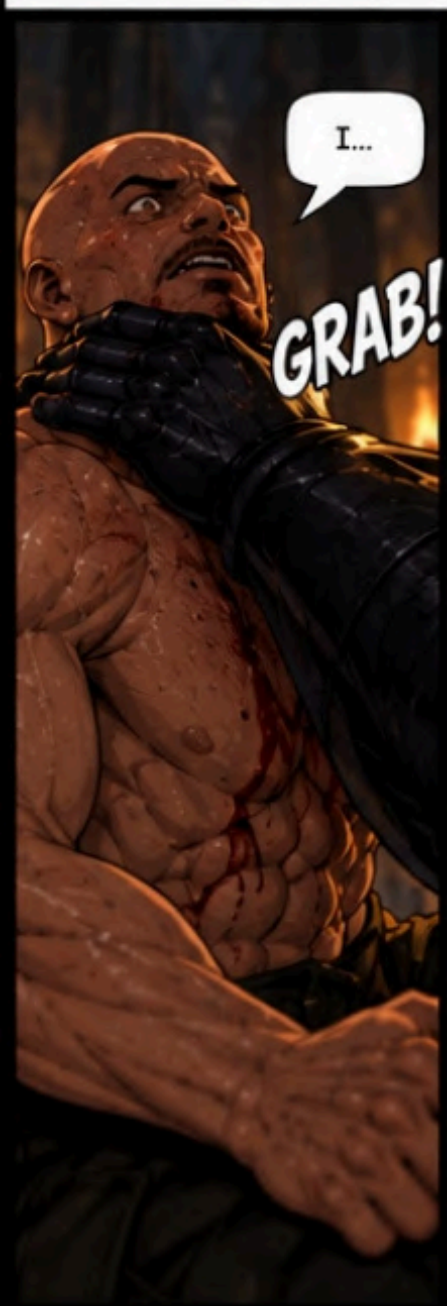
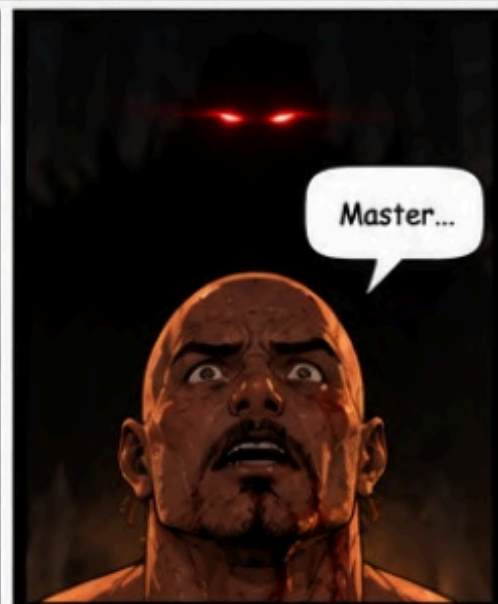
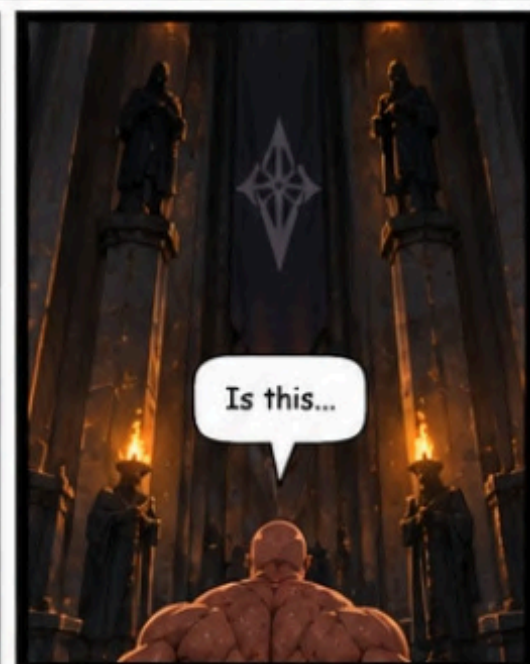
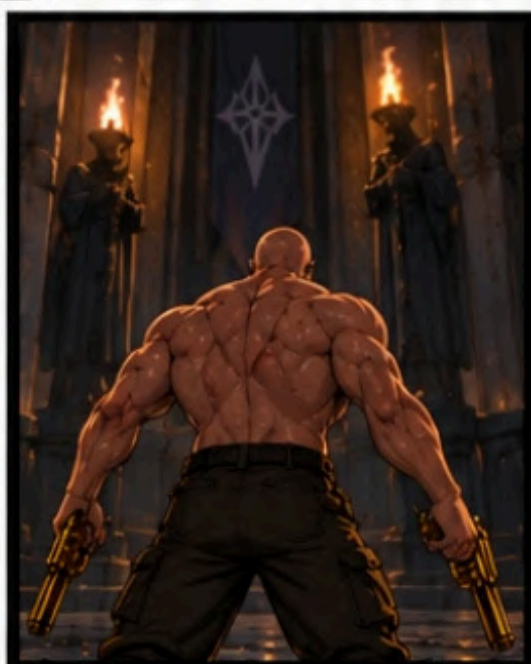
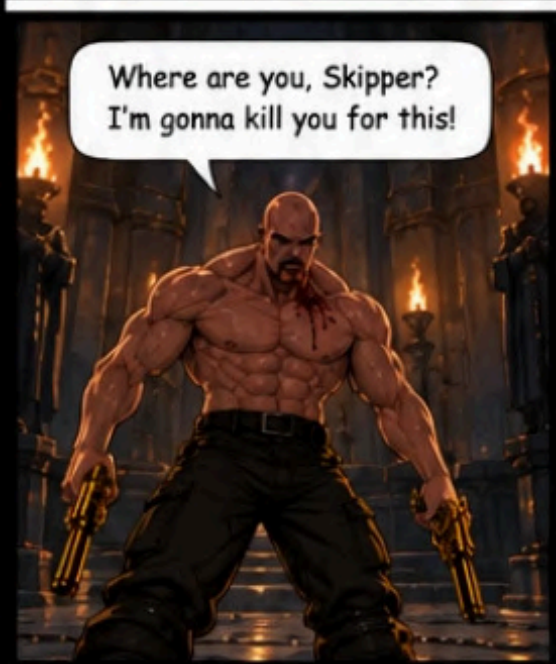
Not my problem.

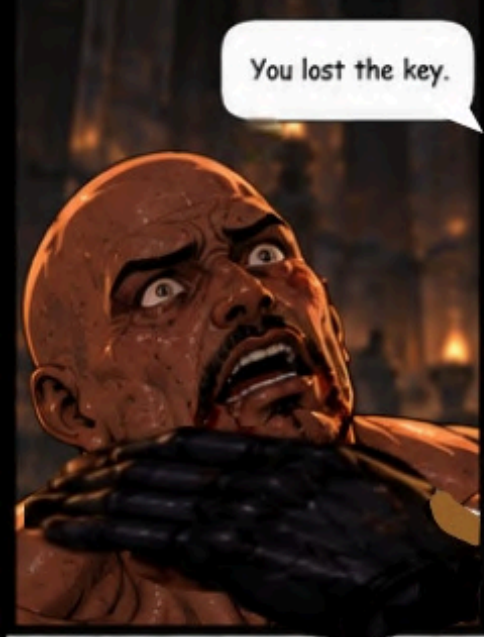


Why am I even
so fucking useless
to anyone?

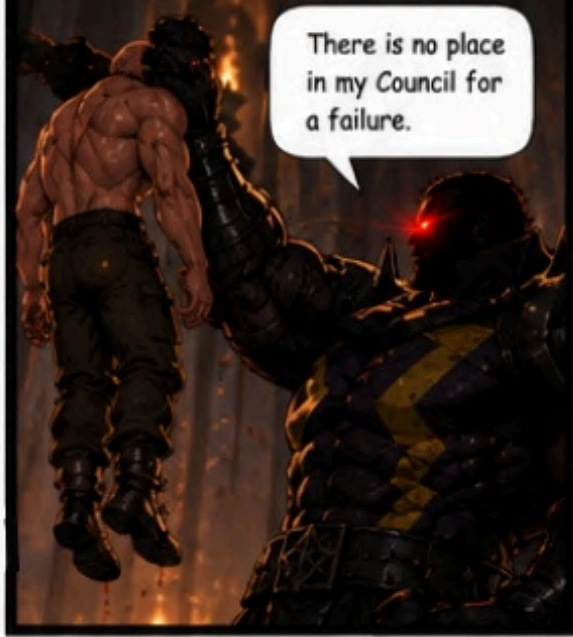




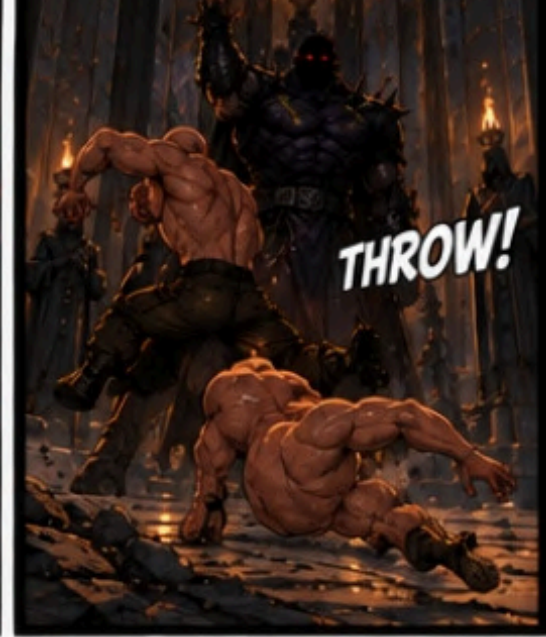




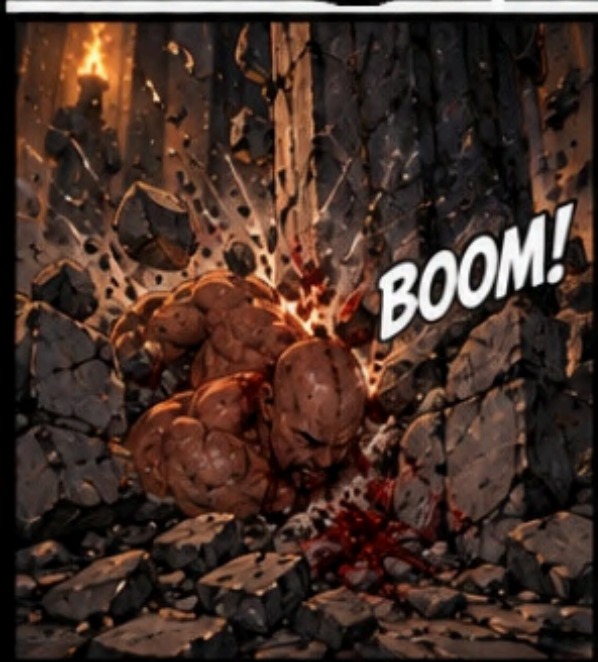
You lost the key.



There is no place
in my Council for
a failure.



THROW!



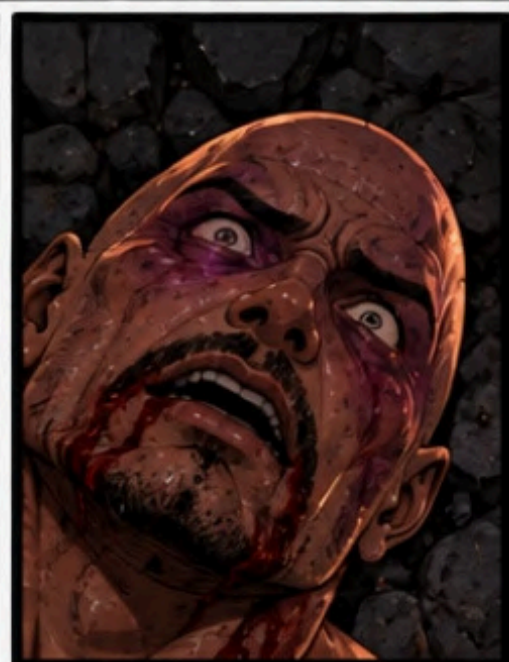
BOOM!



cough...
cough...

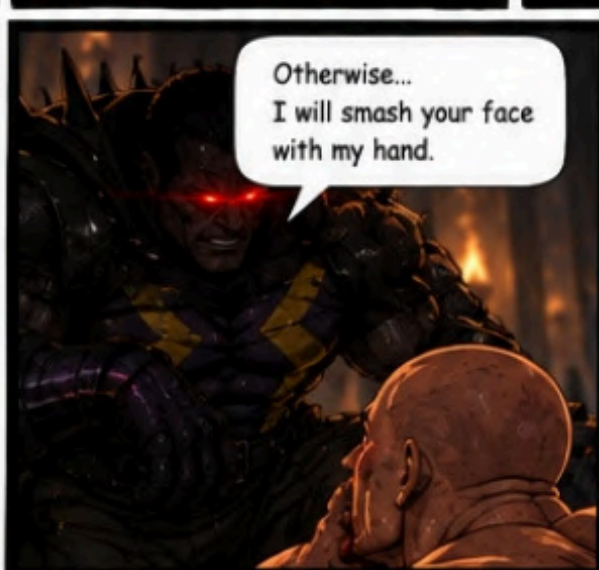


Megasto will return
soon from his time patrol.

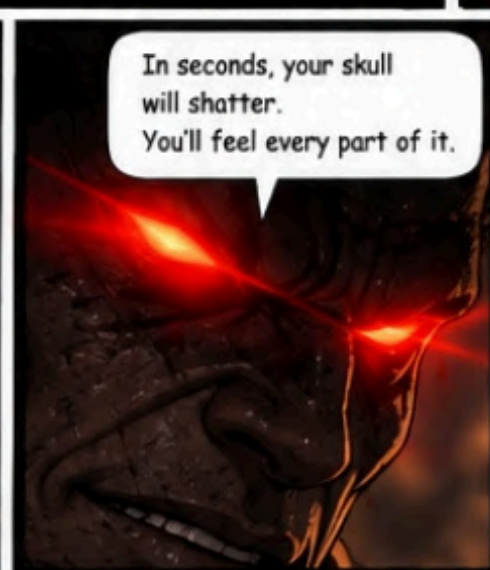


I need that key
before he returns.

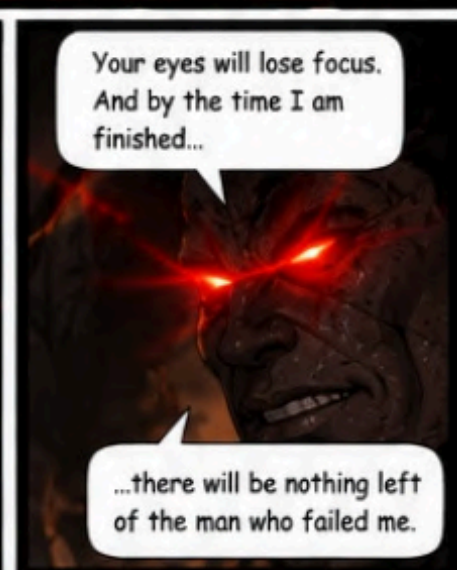
Yes...
Master...



Otherwise...
I will smash your face
with my hand.



In seconds, your skull
will shatter.
You'll feel every part of it.

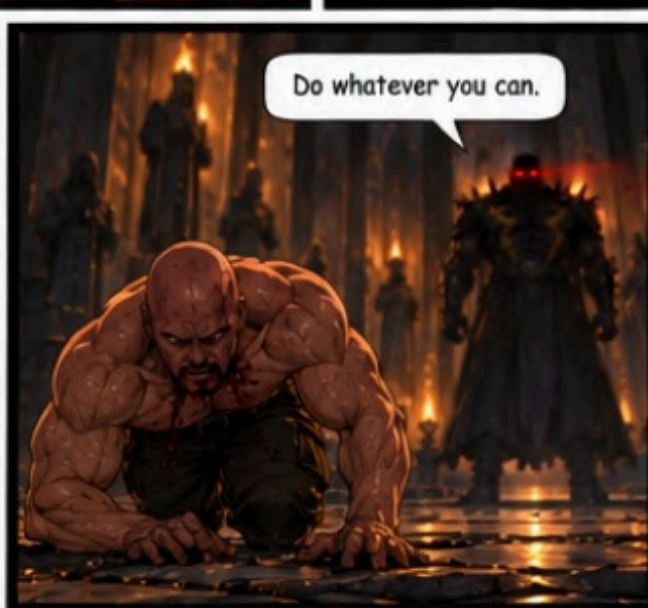


Your eyes will lose focus.
And by the time I am
finished...

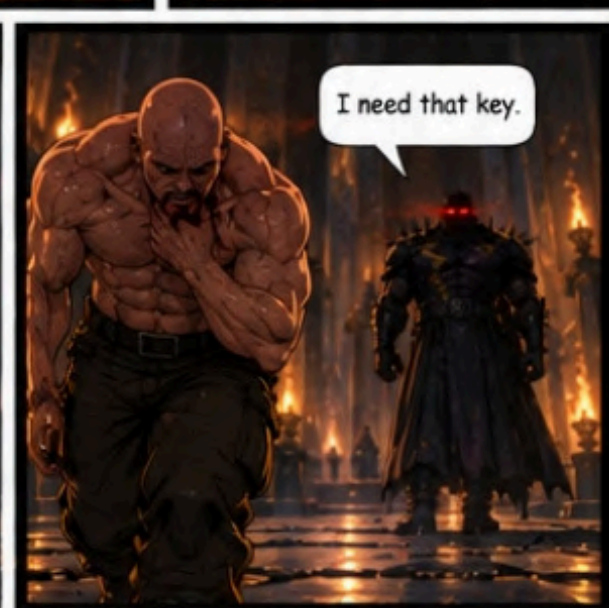
...there will be nothing left
of the man who failed me.



Go.

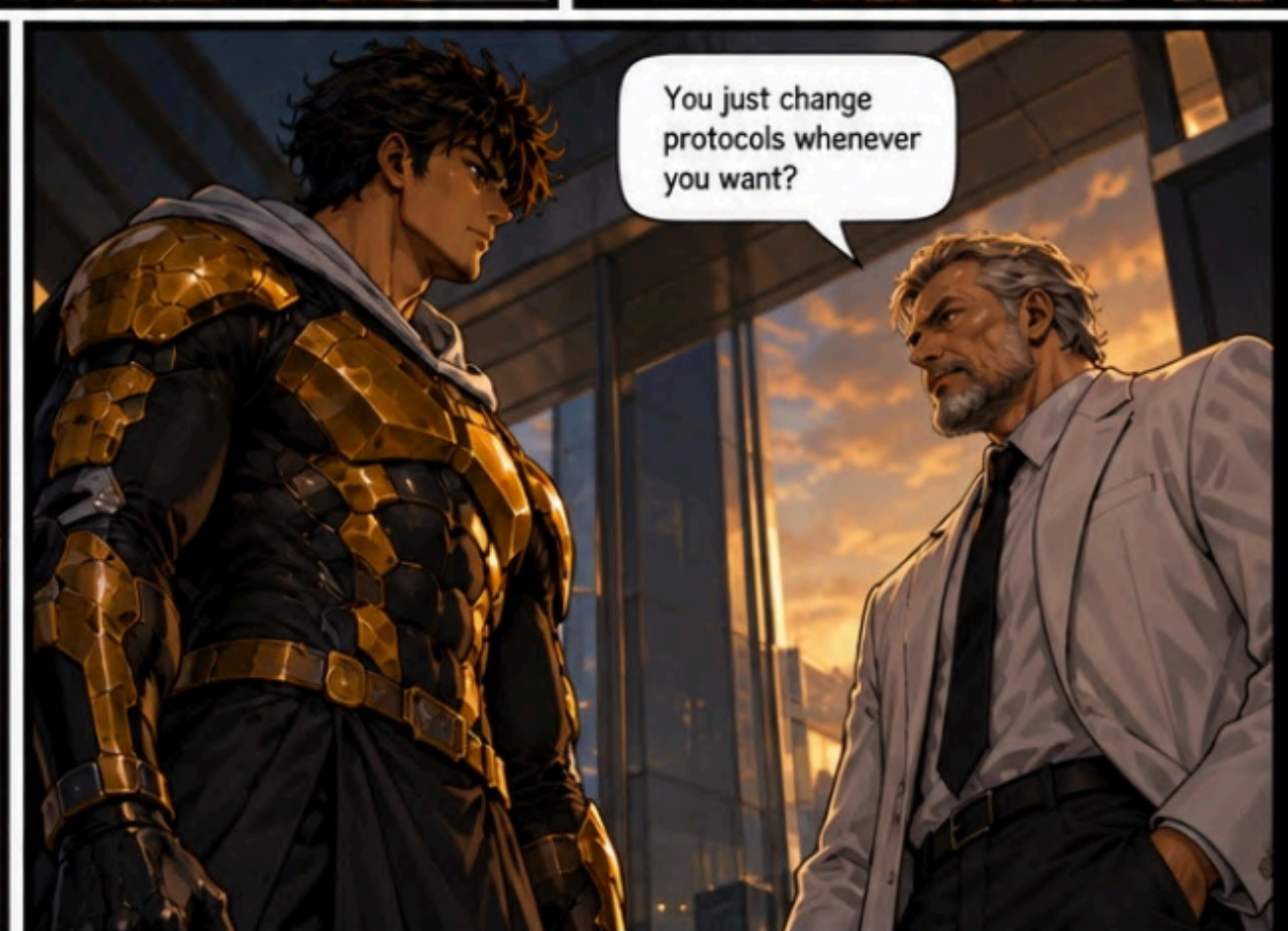
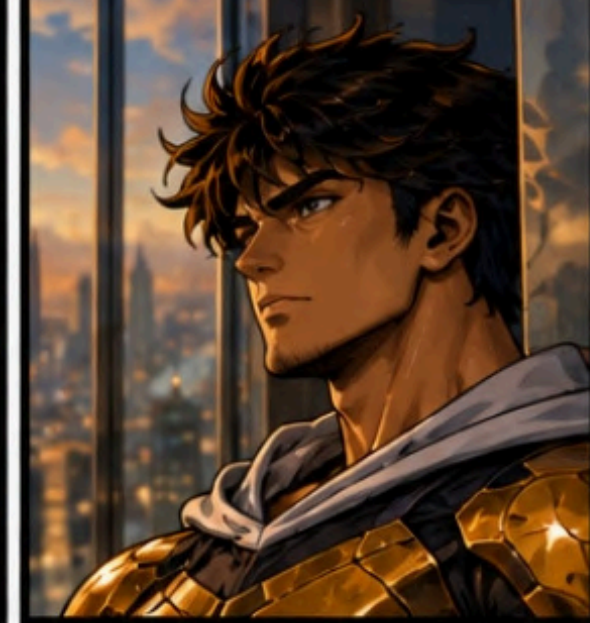


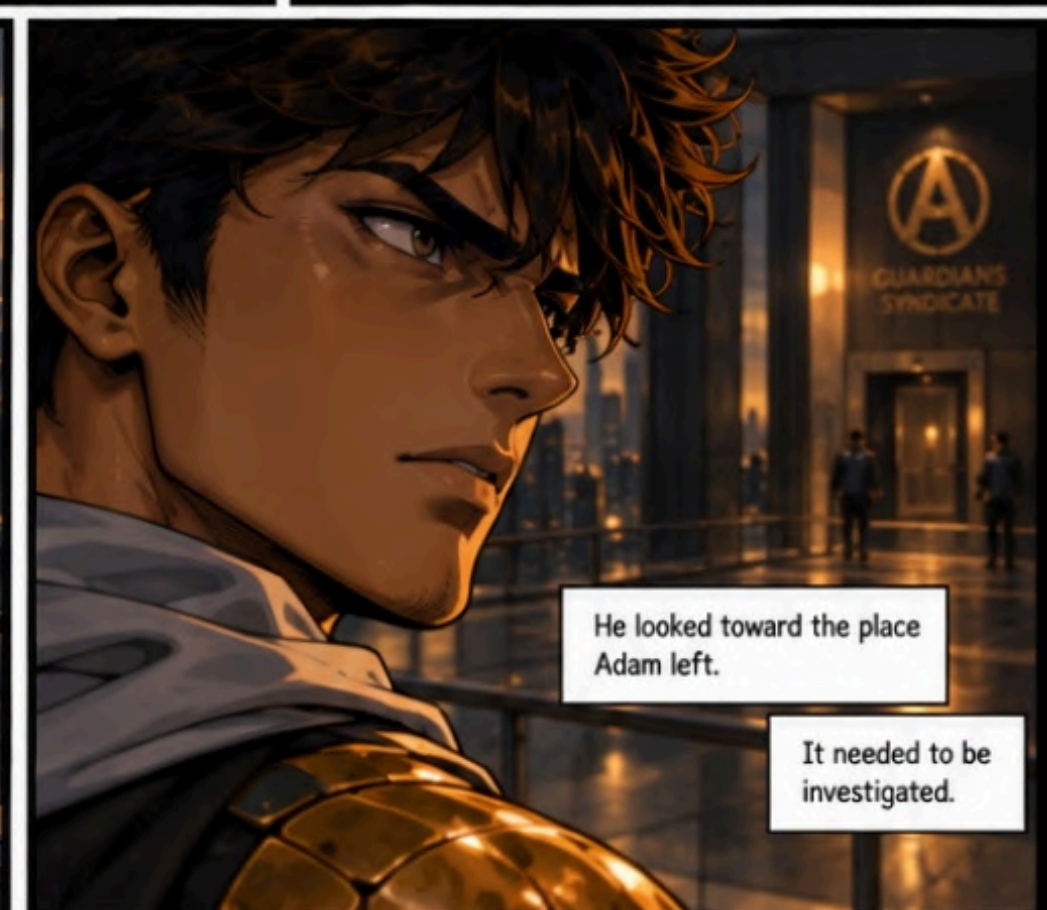
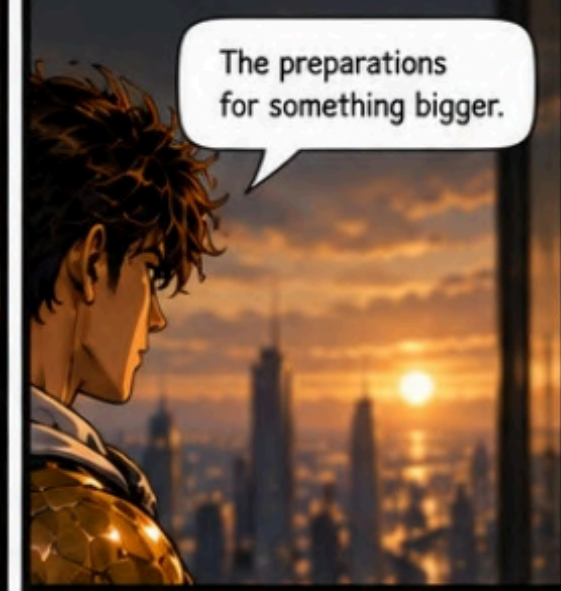
Do whatever you can.

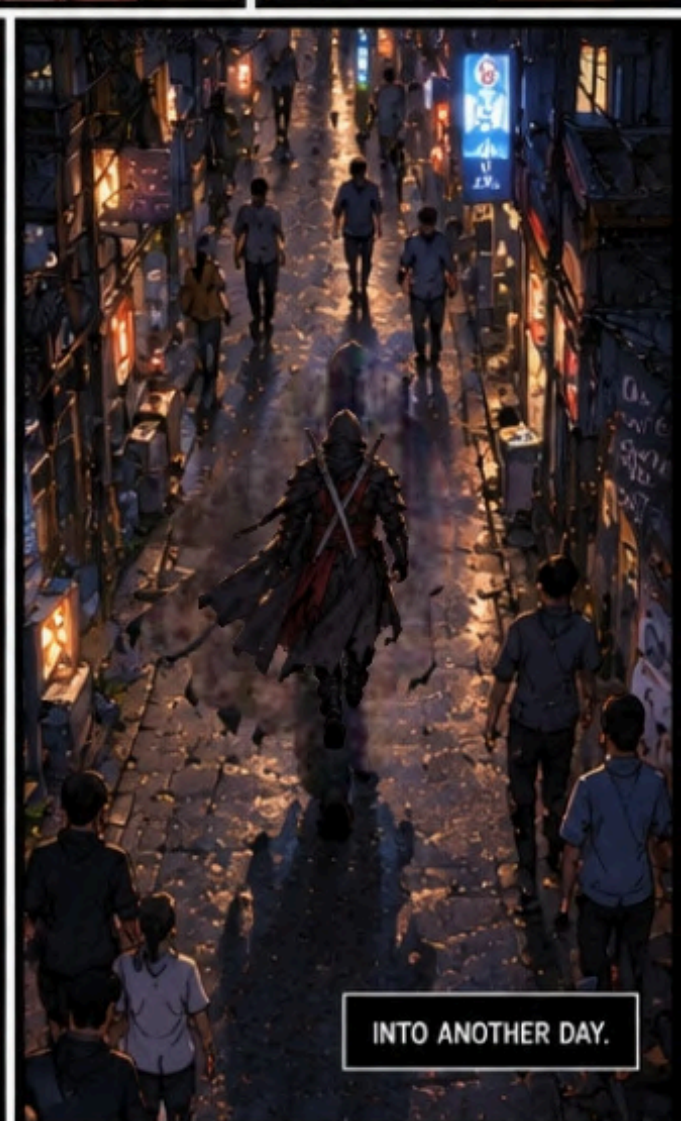
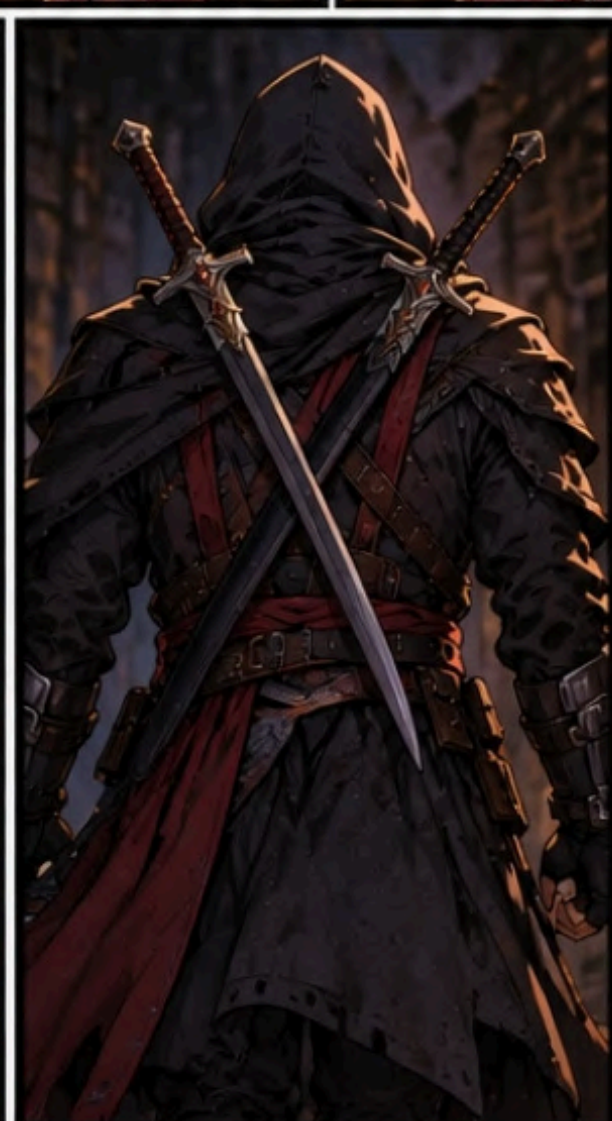
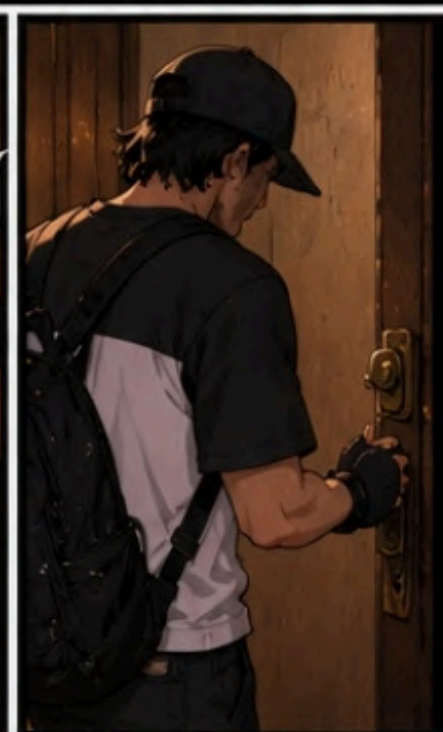
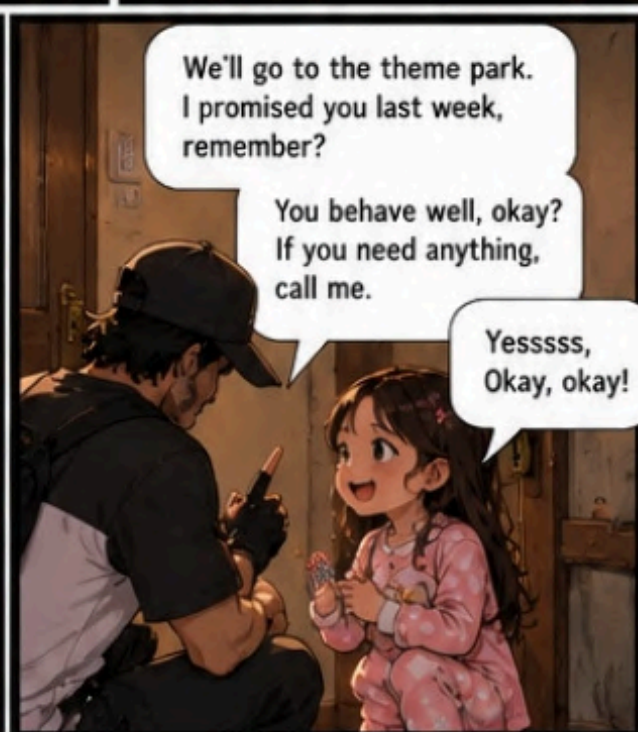


I need that key.

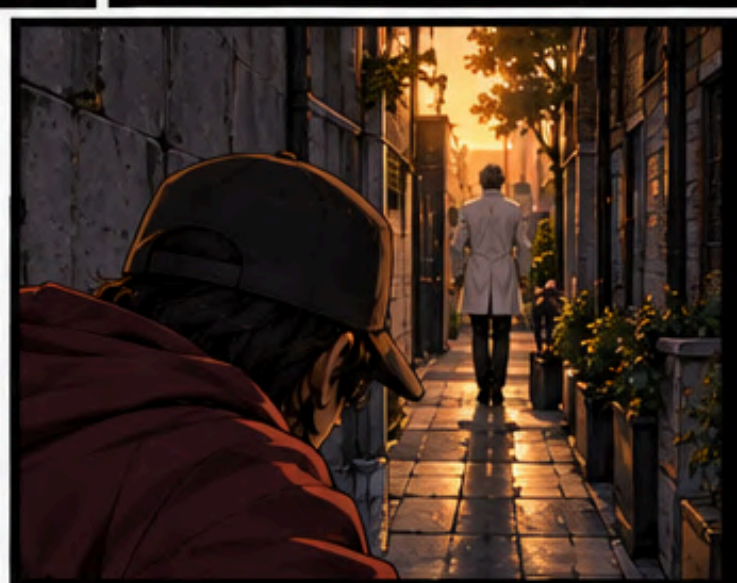
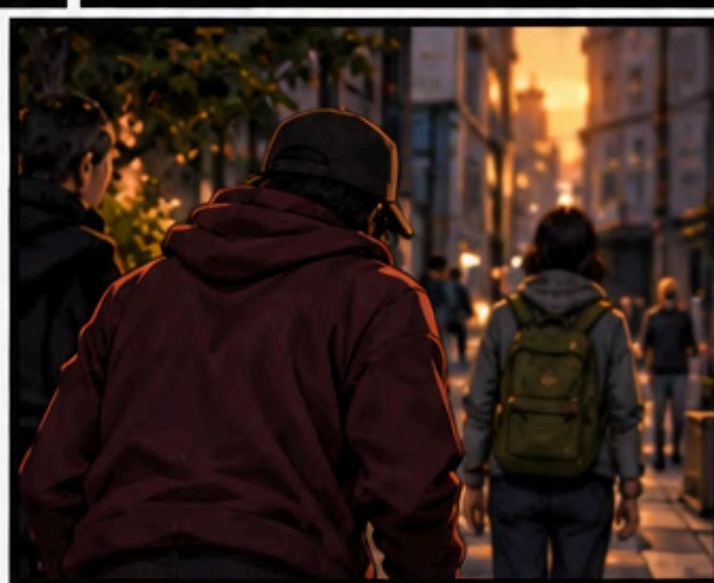


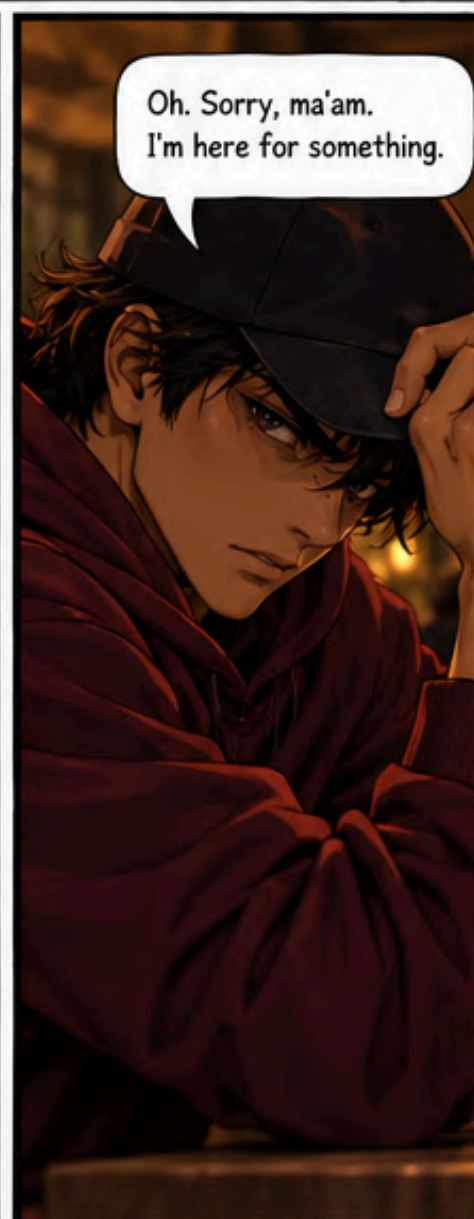
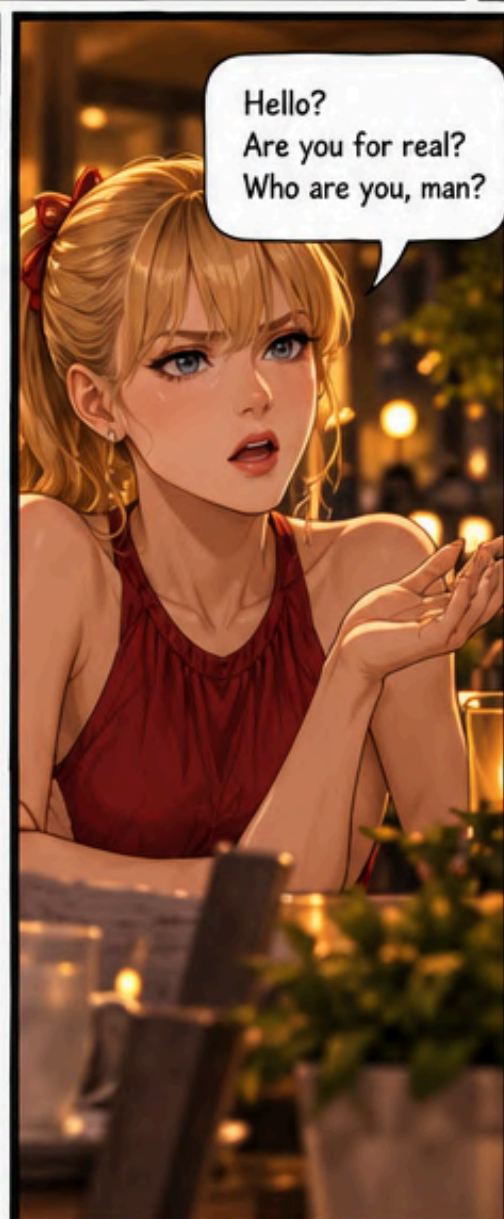
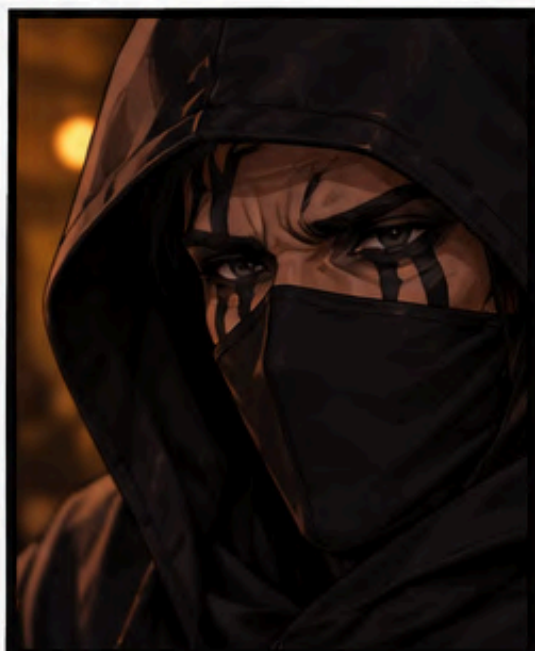
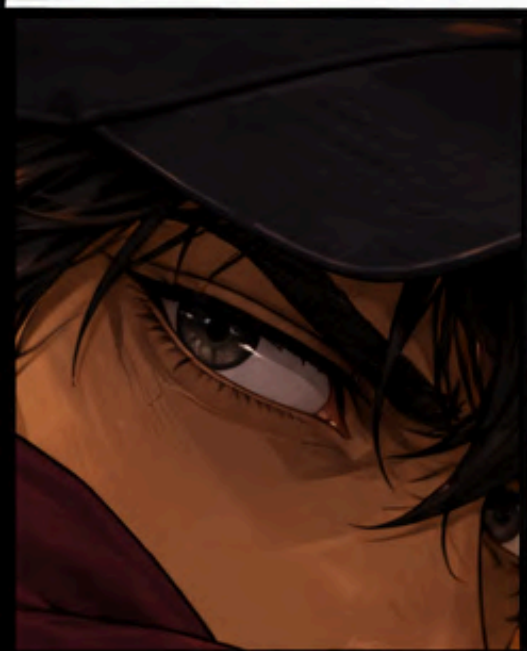


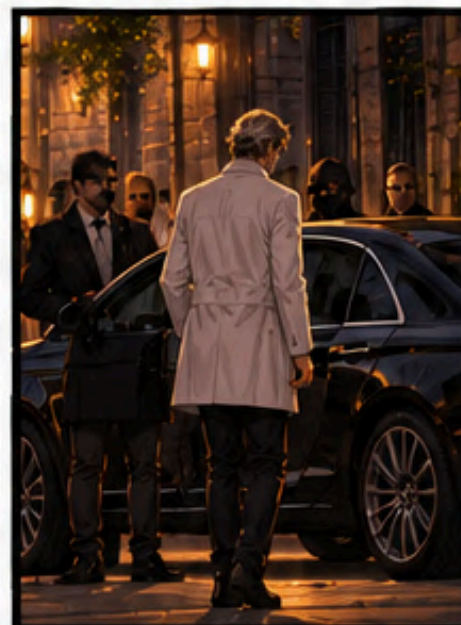
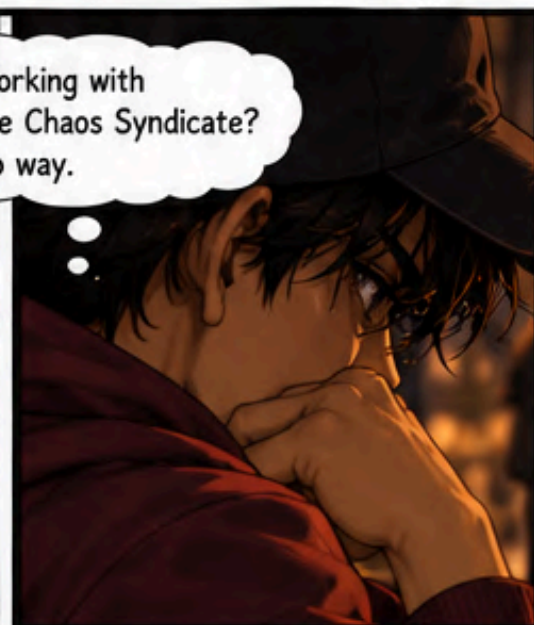
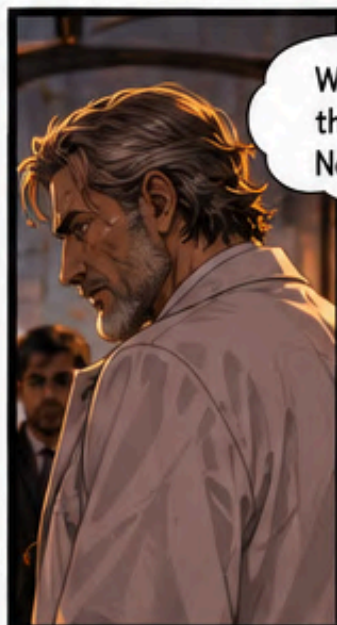
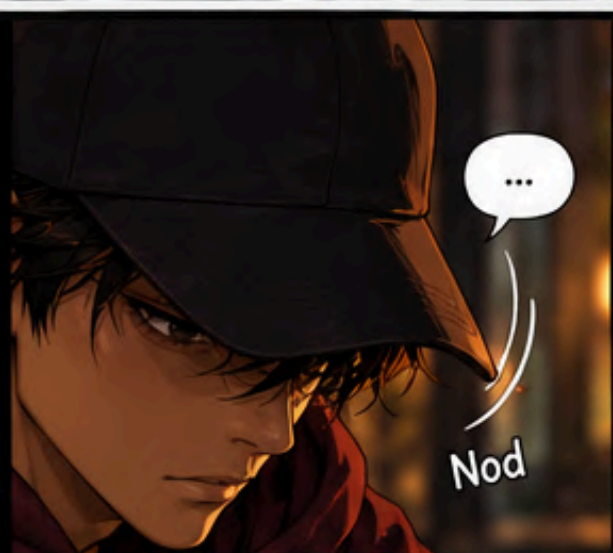




INTO ANOTHER DAY.





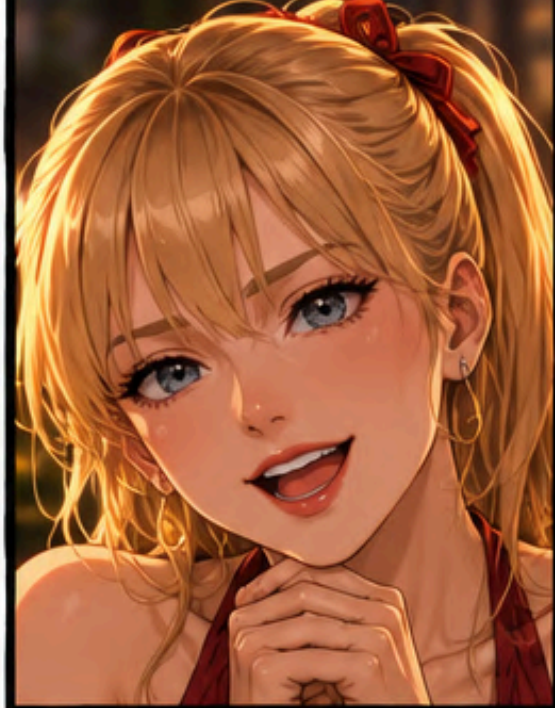




Sir?



Sorry for disturbing you, but I'm Amy Adams. I work in Daily Coverage, but my dream is to work for AshtonDaily. If you could recommend me there, it would be the biggest help of my life.



AshtonDaily?
Me?



Yes, sir. You seem like a bigger reporter there. It would be very grateful of you if you recommended me.



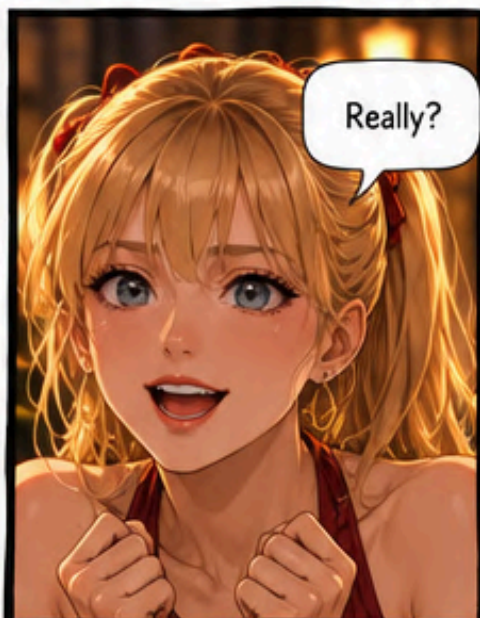
Ma'am, I—



You can call me Amy.



...



Really?



It was a big help, sir. Thank you so much. By the way, this is my card. You can call me anytime.

Amy Adams
Daily Coverage



I've been trying for that job for more than two years, but nothing ever works.



...



Listen, Amy. I'll talk to them. But I'm not sure they'll accept my recommendation.



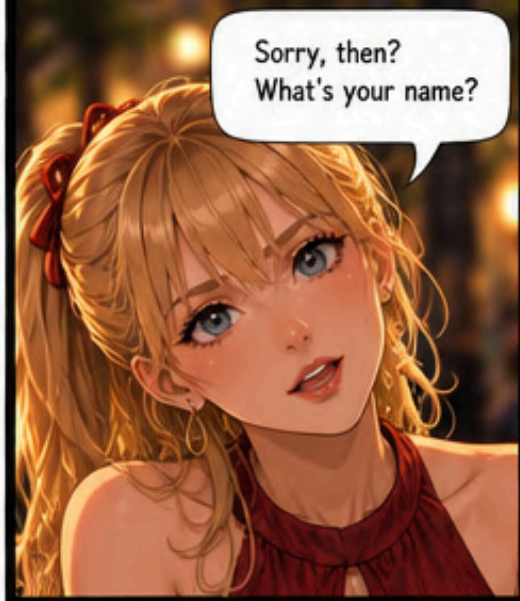
But before that, you need to help me with my investigation. Will you?



I'm very much okay with that. I've been waiting for an opportunity like this, sir.



You don't need to call me sir.



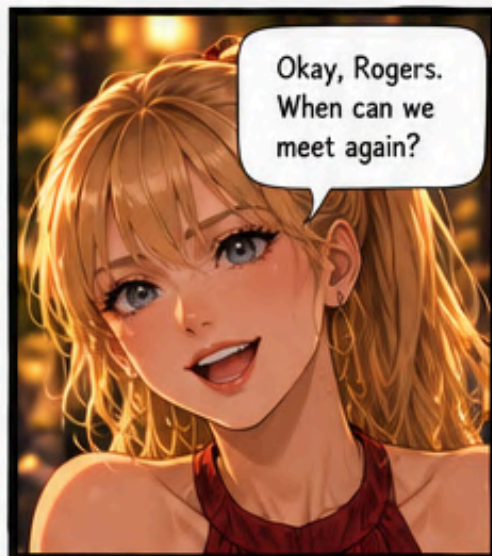
Sorry, then? What's your name?



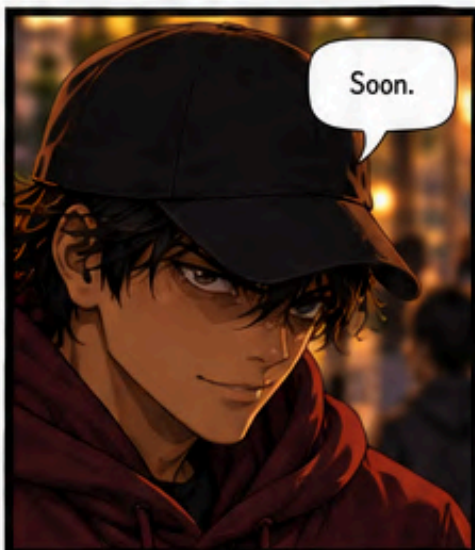
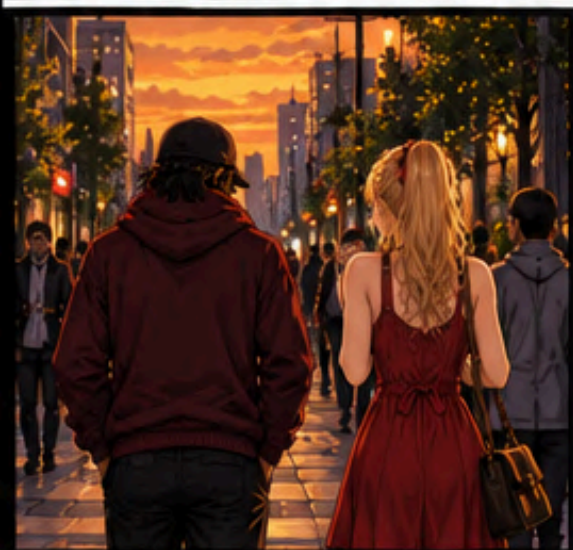
Huh...



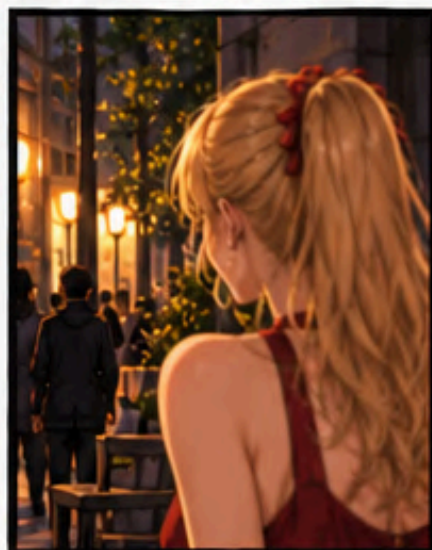
You can call me Rogers.



Okay, Rogers. When can we meet again?



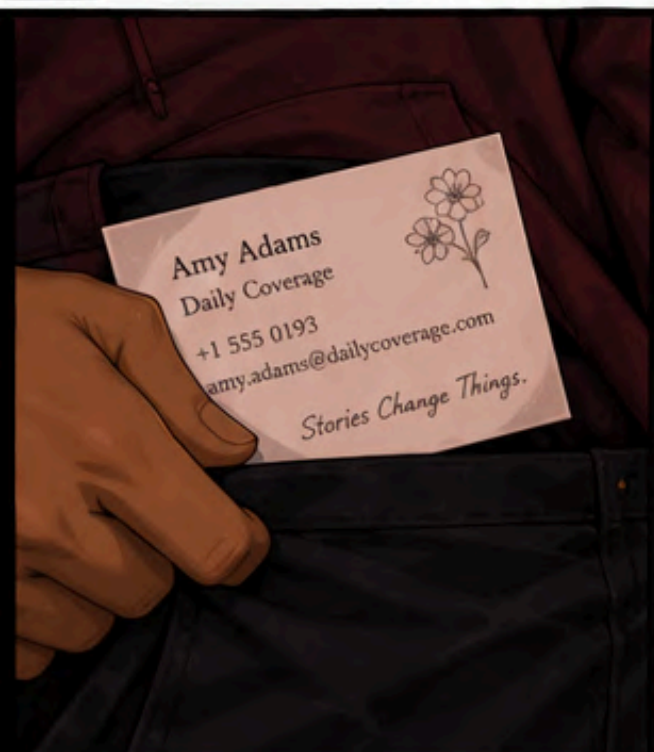
Soon.



Yes!
Finally!

This might be my chance to reach AshtonDaily!

Good
People
Good
Stories
Brighter
Ashton
♡

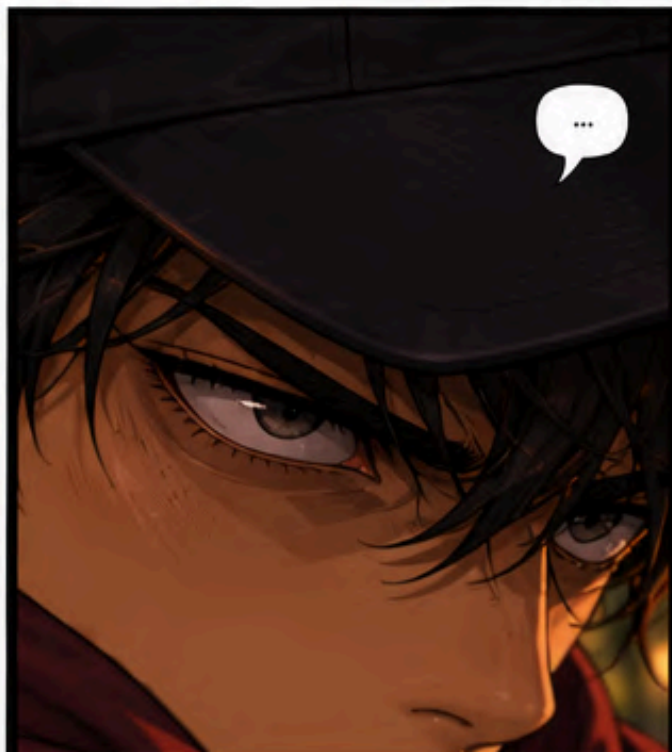


Amy Adams
Daily Coverage
+1 555 0193
amy.adams@dailycoverage.com
Stories Change Things.

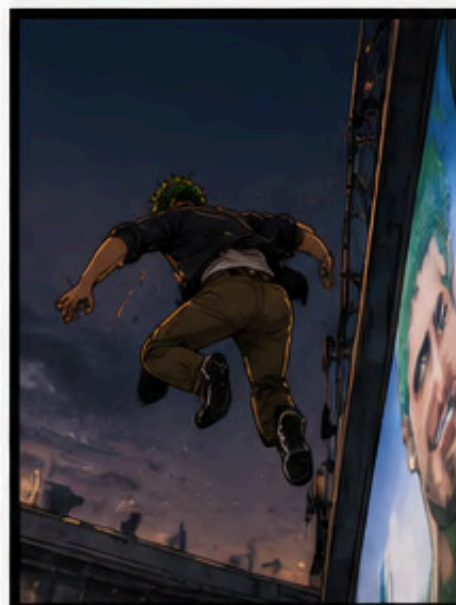


Taylor.

Chaos Syndicate.

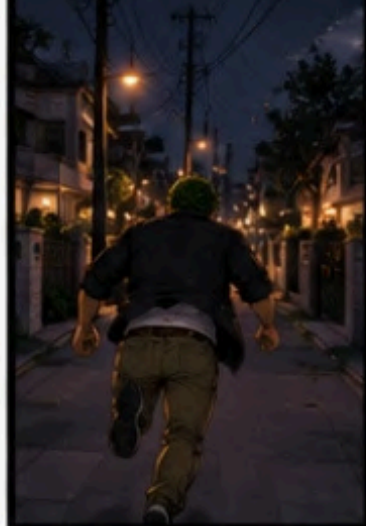


...





What happened to her?



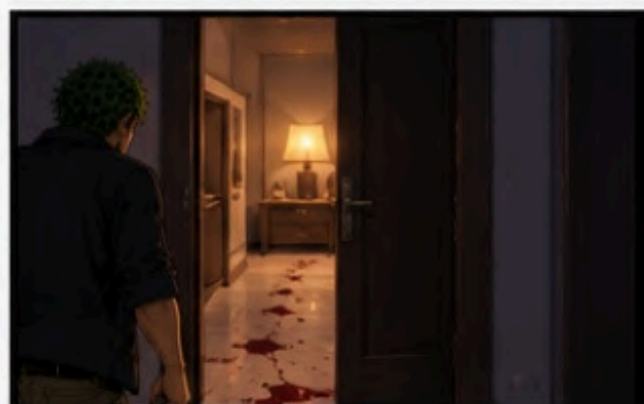
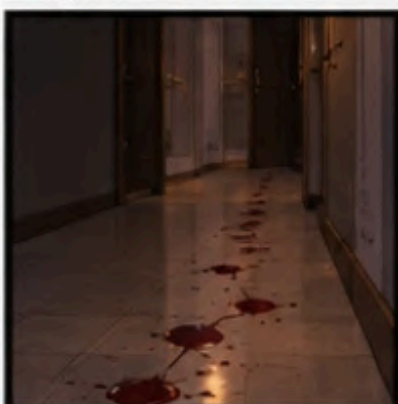
MANDICE!



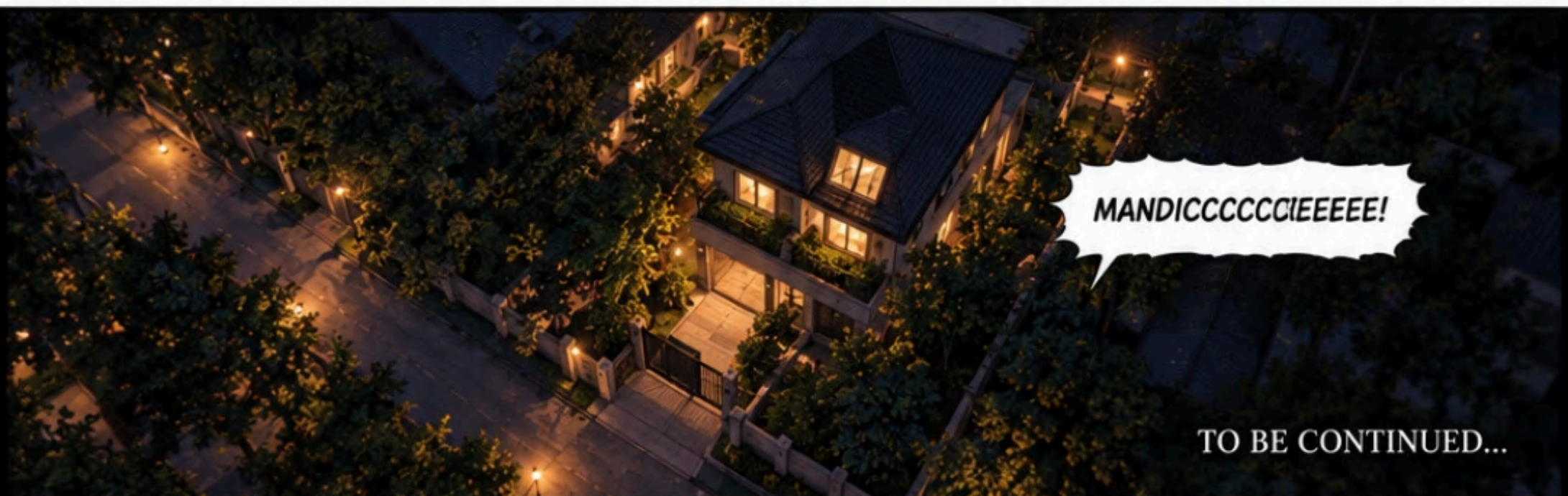
MANDICE!



Mandice...?



MANDIIIIICEEEEE!



MANDICCCCCCIEEEEE!

TO BE CONTINUED...